FACELESS CREATOR KIT

History Facts Shorts *Script Vault*

150 hooks · 60 timed scripts · 30/45/60 s

150	60	8
HISTORY HOOKS	TIMED SCRIPTS	THEMES

Every script names a reference to verify it with, and flags the popular myth where one exists.

PDF · 80 pages · Letter + A4
hooks.csv · scripts.csv · script_beats.csv

Faceless Creator Kit

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How to use this vault

150 history hooks and 60 finished scripts, each timed beat by beat: what to say, what to show, where to pause and how to sound. Seven steps from page to posted video:

1. **Pick a hook**
   Browse the hook library (pages 6–15): 10 hook types, 15 hooks each. Use one as an opener, a title idea or a cover line.

2. **Pick a script**
   Use the script index (page 16) to choose by length (30, 45 or 60 s) and theme. Each script is one page.

3. **Check the "Verify with" line**
   Look the core fact up in the named reference before you record. Read the "Myth check" line so you don't repeat the popular wrong version.

4. **Swap the 3 "Make it yours" points**
   Each script lists 3 concrete swaps: a different opening, focus or question. Change at least one so your video is your own.

5. **Record the voiceover**
   Your own voice or any text-to-speech voice. Read the Voiceover column and pause where the Caption / pause column says.

6. **Add visuals per beat**
   The Visual column names one visual type per beat: a map, a public-domain painting, a museum open-access photo, a simple re-creation or a timeline graphic.

7. **Post it**
   Copy the "Ready to post" box: title, one-line description, 3 hashtags, cover text, and the comment to pin.

The read-speed rule		`2.5 words / second = 150 wpm`
`30 s 55–75 words | 45 s 85–112 | 60 s 115–150 · 2.5 words/s`		
30 s scripts	5 beats	beat 1 = 0–3 s (the hook)
45 s scripts	6 beats	last beat = payoff + comment question
60 s scripts	8 beats	each beat: at most 2.5 × seconds + 2 words

Working in bulk?

The same text is in 3 CSV files: `hooks.csv`, `scripts.csv` (one row per script) and `script_beats.csv` (one row per beat). Import them into Google Sheets or Excel; see README.txt.

Accuracy & platform notes

History channels live or die on trust. Read this once before you post.

How the facts were chosen

- Every script is built on widely documented, non-disputed core events and people who died before 1950; events are before 1992.
- Where sources give different numbers or dates, the script says “about” or “around”, or leaves the number out. Contested figures are flagged (“reportedly”, “debated”).
- No quotes are put in the mouths of historical figures. The only quoted words are well-recorded ones, such as a telegraph message.
- Our build process checked every script for internal consistency: dates, names and numbers match across the page, the CSVs and the hooks.

We are not professional historians

These scripts were written from widely documented history, but they are not academic research and have not been reviewed by professional historians. **Check each fact against the named reference before posting.** The “Verify with” line names where to look; it is a pointer, not a guarantee.

If a viewer corrects you

Thank them, check the point in the named reference, and if they are right, pin a correction comment and fix the description. A visible correction usually builds more trust than silence.

Image and footage rights

Use public-domain paintings and maps, museum open-access images, your own drawings and re-creations, or footage you have the rights to. Check the licence of every image. Never use clips from copyrighted films or shows.

AI voices and disclosure

Follow each platform’s current rules on AI-generated or synthetic content, and turn on its disclosure label whenever a rule applies (for example, realistic AI voices or images).

What this vault does not promise

No script can promise views, followers, monetization or income. This vault saves you research-outline, writing and timing work; the channel is still yours to build.

01
OF 10

Myth vs Reality

Open on something "everyone knows", then knock it down in the next breath. Best with scripts that carry a Myth check note.

`You were taught [POPULAR VERSION]. + [DOCUMENTED VERSION IN 8 WORDS OR FEWER]`

H001	You were taught Napoleon was tiny. He was average height for his time.	Turning-point days	13 w
H002	Medieval people didn't think the Earth was flat. Educated Europeans knew it was round.	Medieval life	14 w
H003	Vikings never wore horned helmets. Blame an 1876 opera.	Medieval life	9 w
H004	Columbus didn't prove the Earth was round. Nobody serious doubted it.	Exploration	11 w
H005	Medieval people drank water too. The "only beer" story is a myth.	Everyday life	12 w
H006	Marie Antoinette probably never said 'Let them eat cake.'	Turning-point days	9 w
H007	The Great Wall isn't visible from the Moon with the naked eye.	Ancient world	12 w
H008	Gladiator fights didn't always end in death. Many fighters walked away.	Ancient world	11 w
H009	Paul Revere never shouted 'The British are coming!'	Turning-point days	8 w
H010	Thomas Edison didn't invent the light bulb. He improved it.	Inventions & science	10 w
H011	Ancient Greek statues weren't plain white. Many were brightly painted.	Ancient world	10 w
H012	You think Cleopatra was Egyptian. Her family was Macedonian Greek.	Ancient world	10 w
H013	Franklin never proposed the turkey as national bird. He praised it in a letter.	Odd laws & customs	14 w
H014	Knights didn't need cranes to climb onto their horses.	Medieval life	9 w
H015	Magellan didn't sail around the world. He died before the voyage ended.	Exploration	12 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

02
OF 10

This Date

A calendar date makes a fact feel like a news flash. Post it on the anniversary, or use it to open any turning-point script.

`On [MONTH DAY], [YEAR], + [WHAT HAPPENED, IN ONE PLAIN CLAUSE]`

H016	On December 17, 1903, a powered plane flew for twelve seconds.	Turning-point days	11 w
H017	On May 24, 1844, a message crossed forty miles in an instant.	Inventions & science	12 w
H018	On September 2, 1666, a London bakery fire began. It burned four days.	Turning-point days	13 w
H019	On September 2, 1752, Britons went to bed and woke up on the 14th.	Turning-point days	14 w
H020	On October 4, 1957, a metal ball started beeping from orbit.	Turning-point days	11 w
H021	On November 9, 1989, a border opened that had split a city for decades.	Turning-point days	14 w
H022	On May 10, 1869, a golden spike finished the first transcontinental railroad.	Turning-point days	12 w
H023	In July 1799, soldiers in Egypt found the stone that unlocked hieroglyphs.	Ancient world	12 w
H024	On August 3, 1492, three ships left Spain. Nobody aboard expected America.	Exploration	12 w
H025	On June 15, 1215, a king agreed to rules he didn't plan to keep.	Medieval life	14 w
H026	On November 8, 1895, a German lab screen glowed when it shouldn't have.	Inventions & science	13 w
H027	On January 10, 1863, London's first underground trains carried passengers.	Everyday life	10 w
H028	On May 6, 1840, the world's first postage stamp became valid.	Everyday life	11 w
H029	On October 4, 1582, parts of Europe went to bed. Tomorrow was October 15.	Turning-point days	14 w
H030	On December 14, 1911, a team reached the South Pole first.	Exploration	11 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

03
OF 10

Day in the Life

Put the viewer inside an old job. Second person ("you") makes everyday history feel personal. Best with Everyday life scripts.

`If you were a [JOB] in [YEAR OR ERA], + [ONE CONCRETE DAILY DETAIL]`

H031	If you were a knocker-upper in 1900, your job was waking people up.	Everyday life	13 w
H032	If you were a medieval scribe, one book could take you months.	Medieval life	12 w
H033	If you were a Roman soldier, you also had to be a builder.	Ancient world	13 w
H034	If you were a sailor in the 1700s, lemons could save your life.	Exploration	13 w
H035	If you were a lamplighter in 1850, you lit a whole street by hand.	Everyday life	14 w
H036	If you built pyramids in Egypt, your wages included bread and beer.	Ancient world	12 w
H037	If you were a telegraph operator in 1870, you could hear words in clicks.	Inventions & science	14 w
H038	If you were a medieval peasant, church feast days gave you days off.	Medieval life	13 w
H039	If you were a Victorian kitchen dog, your job was turning the roast.	Everyday life	13 w
H040	If you were a ship's navigator in 1600, longitude was mostly estimation.	Exploration	12 w
H041	If you were a Roman shopper, lunch came from a street counter.	Everyday life	12 w
H042	If you were a Tudor-era Londoner, the law said what fabric you could wear.	Odd laws & customs	14 w
H043	If you were an ice cutter in 1850, winter was your harvest season.	Everyday life	13 w
H044	If you were a lighthouse keeper in 1880, you trimmed wicks all night.	Exploration	13 w
H045	If you were a London postman in 1900, you delivered several times a day.	Everyday life	14 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

04
OF 10

Object with a Story

Start on one thing you can show: an artefact photo, a map, a museum object. The object is the visual for beat 1.

`This [OBJECT] + [THE ODD THING IT DID OR SHOWS]`

H046	This iron helmet from Norway has no horns. That's the point.	Medieval life	11 w
H047	This broken stone slab let people read hieroglyphs again.	Ancient world	9 w
H048	This corroded bronze lump from a shipwreck turned out to be a gear machine.	Ancient world	14 w
H049	This blurry rooftop view is the oldest surviving camera photograph.	Inventions & science	10 w
H050	This book has been studied for a century. Nobody can read it.	Lost & unsolved	12 w
H051	These chess pieces were carved from walrus ivory and found on a Scottish island.	Medieval life	14 w
H052	This clock solved a problem that sank ships for centuries.	Exploration	10 w
H053	This tiny black stamp changed how the whole world sends letters.	Everyday life	11 w
H054	This golden spike was driven in, then pulled straight back out.	Turning-point days	11 w
H055	This X-ray of a hand shocked the world in 1896.	Inventions & science	10 w
H056	This one carved word is nearly all the Roanoke colonists left behind.	Lost & unsolved	12 w
H057	This old map shows California as an island. Mapmakers copied it for decades.	Exploration	13 w
H058	This Roman dome has stood for nearly 1,900 years without steel inside.	Ancient world	12 w
H059	This Bible was printed with movable metal type around 1455.	Medieval life	10 w
H060	This tin can came with no can opener. That arrived decades later.	Inventions & science	12 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

05 OF 10

How close it came / Near miss

Show how a famous outcome nearly didn't happen. Keep the stakes real but plain: no gore, no exaggeration.

`[FAMOUS OUTCOME] almost didn't happen. + [THE MOMENT IT NEARLY WENT WRONG]`

H061	Every man on Shackleton's Endurance survived after ice crushed the ship.	Exploration	11 w
H062	Magna Carta was cancelled within ten weeks. It survived anyway.	Medieval life	10 w
H063	Gutenberg printed his famous Bible, then lost his workshop in a lawsuit.	Inventions & science	12 w
H064	The clockmaker who solved longitude nearly never got paid for it.	Exploration	11 w
H065	The Rosetta Stone was found by French soldiers. Britain ended up with it.	Ancient world	13 w
H066	The Library of Congress burned in 1814. A former president's books replaced it.	Turning-point days	13 w
H067	In 1911, the Mona Lisa vanished from the Louvre for over two years.	Lost & unsolved	13 w
H068	In 1666, London helped stop a giant fire by blowing up its own houses.	Turning-point days	14 w
H069	The Wright Flyer first flew in America but spent twenty years in London.	Inventions & science	13 w
H070	The ancient gear machine sat in a museum for months before anyone noticed.	Ancient world	13 w
H071	The supply ship for Roanoke arrived three years late. Everyone was gone.	Lost & unsolved	12 w
H072	Five ships left Spain in 1519. Only one sailed all the way around.	Exploration	13 w
H073	In the 1790s, the Bayeux Tapestry was reportedly almost used as a wagon cover.	Medieval life	14 w
H074	The first big telegraph line was meant to run underground. The buried wire failed.	Inventions & science	14 w
H075	The Lewis and Clark expedition lost only one man, most likely to appendicitis.	Exploration	13 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

06
OF 10

Then vs Now

Take something normal today and show how different it was. Great for Everyday life and Odd laws scripts.

`In [YEAR], [NORMAL THING TODAY] + [HOW IT WORKED BACK THEN]`

H076	In 1830, the person receiving a letter in Britain usually paid for it.	Everyday life	13 w
H077	In 1840, many British towns kept their own local time.	Everyday life	10 w
H078	In 1820, summer ice was a luxury cut from frozen New England ponds.	Everyday life	13 w
H079	In 1865, British law limited steam road vehicles to four miles an hour.	Odd laws & customs	13 w
H080	In 1400, almost every book in Europe was copied by hand.	Medieval life	11 w
H081	In 1700, sailors couldn't reliably tell how far east or west they were.	Exploration	13 w
H082	In 1894, nobody had ever seen inside a living body without surgery.	Inventions & science	12 w
H083	In 1700, a Londoner might pay a tax on how many windows they had.	Odd laws & customs	14 w
H084	In 1850, London's sewage flowed straight into the river people drank from.	Turning-point days	12 w
H085	In 79 AD, many Pompeii residents grabbed hot food from street counters.	Everyday life	12 w
H086	In 1750, England's legal year still began on March 25.	Odd laws & customs	10 w
H087	In 1900, nobody had ever stood at the South Pole.	Exploration	10 w
H088	In 1890, nobody had ever flown in a powered, controlled airplane.	Inventions & science	11 w
H089	In 1314, playing football in London's streets could get you jailed.	Odd laws & customs	11 w
H090	In 1950, nothing made by humans had ever orbited Earth.	Inventions & science	10 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

07
OF 10

Forgotten Event

A real, well-documented event most viewers have never heard of. Name the year early so it feels concrete.

`In [YEAR], [PLACE] + [THE EVENT, TOLD IN ONE SURPRISING CLAUSE]`

H091	Before the Mayflower, an English colony vanished from the map.	Lost & unsolved	10 w
H092	In 1858, the Thames smelled so bad Parliament worked behind chemical-soaked curtains.	Turning-point days	12 w
H093	In the 1400s, Chinese fleets reached East Africa, decades before Columbus sailed.	Exploration	12 w
H094	In 1883, a volcano's blast was heard almost 3,000 miles away.	Turning-point days	11 w
H095	In 1816, Europe and North America had a 'year without a summer.'	Turning-point days	12 w
H096	In 1814, a flood of beer swept through a London street.	Everyday life	11 w
H097	Pigs and other animals were once put on trial in European courts.	Odd laws & customs	12 w
H098	In 1859, telegraph wires sparked during a giant solar storm.	Inventions & science	10 w
H099	In the 1560s, Spanish galleons began crossing the Pacific with silver each year.	Exploration	13 w
H100	Roman engineers built tens of thousands of miles of paved roads.	Ancient world	11 w
H101	Turnspit dogs once ran in wheels to roast meat in British kitchens.	Everyday life	12 w
H102	In 1783, a sheep, a duck and a rooster flew in a hot-air balloon.	Inventions & science	14 w
H103	A Viking settlement in Canada sat forgotten until the 1960s.	Exploration	10 w
H104	Medieval London had a bridge lined with houses and shops.	Medieval life	10 w
H105	Around 1259 BC, Egypt and the Hittites signed a written peace treaty.	Ancient world	12 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

08
OF 10

Number Shock

Lead with one widely documented number. Round it and say “about” where sources differ; never invent a precise figure.

`[ONE WIDELY DOCUMENTED NUMBER] + [WHAT MAKES IT SURPRISING]`

H106	Cleopatra lived closer to the Moon landing than to the Great Pyramid’s construction.	Ancient world	13 w
H107	Cologne Cathedral took over 600 years to finish.	Medieval life	8 w
H108	About 18 of roughly 270 men finished the first voyage around the world.	Exploration	13 w
H109	The first photograph needed an exposure of many hours, maybe days.	Inventions & science	11 w
H110	Britain’s window tax lasted 155 years.	Odd laws & customs	6 w
H111	The first powered flight covered 120 feet, less than a jumbo jet’s wingspan.	Turning-point days	13 w
H112	The Pantheon’s dome is about 43 meters across, and it’s unreinforced concrete.	Ancient world	12 w
H113	Sputnik circled Earth about once every 96 minutes.	Turning-point days	8 w
H114	Gutenberg printed about 180 Bibles. Fewer than 50 survive today.	Medieval life	10 w
H115	Measured with all its branches, the Great Wall runs over 13,000 miles.	Ancient world	12 w
H116	Roanoke’s colonists numbered about 115. None were ever found.	Lost & unsolved	9 w
H117	The Voynich manuscript has about 240 pages nobody can read.	Lost & unsolved	10 w
H118	Zheng He’s first fleet reportedly carried around 27,000 people.	Exploration	9 w
H119	Ancient Rome’s Colosseum could seat about 50,000 people.	Ancient world	8 w
H120	On an 81-day voyage to Jamaica, Harrison’s watch lost about five seconds.	Exploration	12 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

09
OF 10

Strange-but-true Law or custom

A real rule or custom that sounds made up. Name the place and the century so viewers can look it up.

`In [PLACE AND CENTURY], the law said + [THE STRANGE RULE]`

H121	Russian men once paid a tax to keep their beards.	Odd laws & customs	10 w
H122	England's Tudor laws decided who could wear purple silk.	Odd laws & customs	9 w
H123	In 1386, a French town reportedly dressed a pig in clothes for its trial.	Odd laws & customs	14 w
H124	Roman laundries collected urine on purpose, and the emperor taxed it.	Ancient world	11 w
H125	England's kings banned football so men would practice archery instead.	Odd laws & customs	10 w
H126	British drivers once needed someone walking ahead waving a red flag.	Odd laws & customs	11 w
H127	In 1795, Britain made anyone using hair powder buy a yearly certificate.	Odd laws & customs	12 w
H128	In 1266, English law tied the weight of a loaf to grain prices.	Medieval life	13 w
H129	During Saturnalia, Roman masters sometimes served dinner to the people they enslaved.	Ancient world	12 w
H130	Some medieval church courts heard cases against insects that ate crops.	Odd laws & customs	11 w
H131	In Victorian Britain, widows were expected to wear mourning clothes for about two years.	Everyday life	14 w
H132	Tudor England fined people for not going to church.	Odd laws & customs	9 w
H133	Ancient Athens could vote to banish a citizen for ten years, no crime needed.	Ancient world	14 w
H134	In Edo-period Japan, only samurai could legally wear two swords.	Odd laws & customs	10 w
H135	A 1336 English law limited most people's meals to two courses.	Medieval life	11 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

10
OF 10

Unsolved or Lost

A real open question. Say clearly what is known and what is not; never present a theory or a paranormal idea as fact.

`[THING] is still unsolved. + [WHAT WE ACTUALLY KNOW]`

H136	An entire English colony disappeared, leaving one word carved on a post.	Lost & unsolved	12 w
H137	Thousands of Indus Valley seals survive. Nobody can read a single one.	Lost & unsolved	12 w
H138	A ship was found sailing with nobody aboard. The crew was never found.	Lost & unsolved	13 w
H139	Amelia Earhart's plane vanished in 1937, and searchers never found it.	Lost & unsolved	11 w
H140	A Roman legion vanishes from the records. Nobody knows exactly what happened.	Ancient world	12 w
H141	The Library of Alexandria's lost books: nobody knows how many there were.	Ancient world	12 w
H142	One medieval book is written in a script no one has cracked.	Medieval life	12 w
H143	Where is Cleopatra buried? Archaeologists still don't know.	Ancient world	8 w
H144	Leonardo's lost Florence mural may lie behind a later wall. Nobody has proven it.	Lost & unsolved	14 w
H145	Genghis Khan's tomb has never been found.	Lost & unsolved	7 w
H146	Shakespeare co-wrote a play called Cardenio. No copy of it survives.	Lost & unsolved	11 w
H147	What caused the 1518 dancing plague? Historians still argue about it.	Lost & unsolved	11 w
H148	Who built the ancient gear machine found off Antikythera? Nobody knows.	Ancient world	11 w
H149	Why did the Maya leave their great southern cities? There's still no single answer.	Lost & unsolved	14 w
H150	The Phaistos Disc's spiral of symbols has never been deciphered.	Ancient world	10 w

Say it, then check it. About 3–6 s each at 2.5 words/s; up to 9 words fit the 0–3 s hook beat, so let a longer hook run into beat 2. Every hook states a real fact: check it in a general reference before you post.

Script index

60 scripts: 20 × 30 s, 20 × 45 s, 20 × 60 s, across 8 themes. Each story is written at one length only. Click an ID or title to jump to it.

ID	TITLE	THEME	LENGTH	WORDS	PAGE
S01	Cleopatra, the Pyramids and the Moon Landing	Ancient world	30 s	66	18
S02	Medieval People Knew the Earth Was Round	Medieval life	30 s	67	19
S03	Magellan Didn't Finish His Own Voyage	Exploration & navigation	30 s	61	20
S04	The World's Oldest Surviving Camera Photo	Inventions & science history	30 s	62	21
S05	Peter the Great Taxed Beards	Odd laws & customs	30 s	63	22
S06	The Great Fire of London Began in a Bakery	Turning-point days	30 s	62	23
S07	Did Medieval People Only Drink Beer?	Everyday life in the past	30 s	70	24
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S10	The Bayeux Tapestry Isn't a Tapestry	Medieval life	30 s	64	27
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S12	Ben Franklin's Kite Wasn't Struck by Lightning	Inventions & science history	30 s	69	29
S13	England Had Laws About Who Could Wear Purple	Odd laws & customs	30 s	67	30
S14	The Night the Berlin Wall Opened	Turning-point days	30 s	60	31
S15	Knocker-Uppers: Alarm Clocks With a Long Stick	Everyday life in the past	30 s	65	32
S16	The Library of Alexandria Didn't Burn in One Night	Lost & unsolved	30 s	62	33
S17	You Can't See the Great Wall From the Moon	Ancient world	30 s	63	34
S18	Cologne Cathedral Took Over 600 Years to Finish	Medieval life	30 s	66	35
S19	Vikings Reached America 500 Years Before Colu...	Exploration & navigation	30 s	59	36
S20	Ada Lovelace Wrote About Computers in 1843	Inventions & science history	30 s	64	37
S21	When Europe Put Pigs on Trial	Odd laws & customs	45 s	94	38
S22	The First Powered Flight Lasted 12 Seconds	Turning-point days	45 s	89	39
S23	The Man Who Shipped Ice Around the World	Everyday life in the past	45 s	91	40
S24	The Voynich Manuscript Nobody Can Read	Lost & unsolved	45 s	88	41
S25	The Pyramid Builders Weren't Slaves	Ancient world	45 s	92	42
S26	Did Medieval People Really Die at 30?	Medieval life	45 s	88	43
S27	China's Treasure Fleets Sailed Before Columbus	Exploration & navigation	45 s	89	44
S28	The First Long-Distance Telegraph Message	Inventions & science history	45 s	86	45
S29	Britain's Tax on Windows	Odd laws & customs	45 s	87	46
S30	The Year Britain Skipped 11 Days	Turning-point days	45 s	88	47

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S37	English Kings Kept Banning Football	Odd laws & customs	45 s	88	54
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S46	The Great Stink That Gave London Its Sewers	Turning-point days	60 s	129	63
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S49	The Antikythera Mechanism: An Ancient Gear Ma...	Ancient world	60 s	118	66
S50	The Lewis Chessmen Found on a Scottish Island	Medieval life	60 s	117	67
S51	Shackleton's Endurance: Every Crew Member Su...	Exploration & navigation	60 s	121	68
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S53	Britain's Hair Powder Tax	Odd laws & customs	60 s	119	70
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S60	Canned Food Came Before the Can Opener	Inventions & science history	60 s	116	77

Cleopatra, the Pyramids and the Moon Landing

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Cleopatra lived closer to us than to the pyramids.	Ancient coin portrait of Cleopatra, museum open-access photo	▶ Big card: CLOSER TO US	Playful
3–9	The Great Pyramid of Giza was finished around 2560 BC. Cleopatra died in 30 BC.	Timeline graphic: pyramid icon at 2560 BC	Highlight “2560 BC”	Clear
9–16	That gap is roughly 2,500 years. To her, the pyramids were already ancient monuments.	Timeline stretches; 2,500-year bar fills in	❚❚ Pause after “ancient”	Amazed
16–23	Now count forward. From Cleopatra to the Moon landing in 1969 is about 2,000 years.	Timeline extends to a rocket icon at 1969	▶ New card per number	Building
23–30 CTA	Egypt’s history is that deep. Which other timeline should I line up next?	Full timeline, three icons, slow zoom out	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Pyramids of Giza” and “Cleopatra” entries
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Add mammoths: some survived on Wrangel Island while the pyramids were built.
2. Use the first powered flight, 1903, as the modern endpoint instead.
3. Ask viewers to guess the gap before you reveal the numbers.

Ready to post

TITLE Cleopatra, the Pyramids and the Moon Landing

DESCRIPTION Cleopatra, the Great Pyramid and the Moon landing on one timeline.

HASHTAGS #history #ancientegypt #historyfacts

COVER TEXT Closer to us!

PIN Which two events should I put on one timeline next?

Medieval People Knew the Earth Was Round

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Medieval people did not think the Earth was flat.	Medieval round-world map (public domain); flat map crossed out	▶ Big card: NOT FLAT	Confident
3–9	Scholars like the English monk Bede, around 700, wrote about a round Earth.	Manuscript page photo, museum open-access	Label “Bede, c. 700”	Calm
9–16	Medieval kings even held a ball with a cross, a symbol of rule over the world.	Artefact photo: royal orb	Highlight “a ball”	Curious
16–23	The flat-Earth story mostly spread in the 1800s, in popular books about Columbus.	Timeline graphic: 700 → 1800s	⏸ Pause before “1800s”	Reveal
23–30 CTA	So the myth is newer than the people it describes. What myth should I check next?	Round world painting, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Flat Earth” and “Bede” entries
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** Medieval Europeans believed the Earth was flat. **Documented:** Educated medieval writers described a round Earth; the flat-Earth story spread in the 1800s.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on a medieval globe-and-cross symbol of royal power instead.
2. Name Bede’s book on time-reckoning as your main example.
3. End by asking which school “fact” viewers want checked.

Ready to post

TITLE Medieval People Knew the Earth Was Round

DESCRIPTION Why the medieval flat-Earth belief is a much later myth.

HASHTAGS #history #medieval #mythbusting

COVER TEXT They knew it was round

PIN Who first told you medieval people thought the Earth was flat?

Magellan Didn't Finish His Own Voyage

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Magellan never actually sailed around the world.	Old map of Magellan's route (public domain)	▶ Big card: NEVER	Bold
3–9	Five ships left Spain in 1519, led by Ferdinand Magellan, heading west.	Map: five ship icons leave Spain	Label "1519"	Steady
9–16	In 1521 Magellan was killed in a fight in the Philippines, partway through the trip.	Map pin on the Philippines	❚❚ Pause after "Philippines"	Serious
16–23	Juan Sebastián Elcano took over. In 1522 one ship, the Victoria, reached Spain again.	Map: one ship completes the loop	Highlight "one ship"	Reveal
23–30 CTA	About eighteen men made it home. Who do you think deserves the credit?	Freeze on full route map	Hold question 1.5 s	Direct

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Ferdinand Magellan" and "Juan Sebastián del Cano" entries
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** Magellan sailed all the way around the world. **Documented:** Magellan died in the Philippines in 1521; Elcano brought one ship home in 1522.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the ship Victoria and reveal Magellan's fate at the end.
2. Swap the crew numbers for the length: about three years at sea.
3. Ask viewers which explorer gets too much credit.

Ready to post

TITLE Magellan Didn't Finish His Own Voyage

DESCRIPTION The first trip around the world, and who actually finished it.

HASHTAGS #history #exploration #magellan

COVER TEXT He never made it home

PIN Which explorer should I cover next?

The World's Oldest Surviving Camera Photo

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	This blurry rooftop view took hours to photograph.	Museum open-access image of the Niépce heliograph	▶ Big card: HOURS	Intrigued
3–9	Around 1826, Nicéphore Niépce pointed a camera out of a window in France.	Simple re-creation: window, camera box sketch	Label "c. 1826"	Storyteller
9–16	He used a plate coated with bitumen that hardened slowly in sunlight.	Diagram: light hits a coated plate	⏸ Pause after "sunlight"	Explaining
16–23	The exposure probably took many hours, maybe days. It's the oldest surviving camera photograph.	Slow zoom on the rooftops	Highlight "oldest surviving"	Amazed
23–30 CTA	Today that takes a split second. What would you photograph if you had one shot?	Phone camera icon beside the heliograph	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Harry Ransom Center, University of Texas at Austin: Niépce heliograph · Britannica "Nicéphore Niépce"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Compare the exposure to a phone photo taken in a split second.
2. Open on the photo itself and reveal the date afterwards.
3. Ask viewers what they would photograph with one shot.

Ready to post

TITLE The World's Oldest Surviving Camera Photo

DESCRIPTION The blurry rooftop view that became the oldest surviving camera photo.

HASHTAGS #history #photography #inventions

COVER TEXT Hours for one photo

PIN What should the next oldest-thing video be about?

Peter the Great Taxed Beards

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Russian men once paid a tax to keep beards.	Artefact photo: bronze beard tax token	▶ Big card: BEARD TAX	Playful
3–9	In 1698, Tsar Peter the Great wanted Russia to look more like western Europe.	Period portrait of Peter I (public domain)	Label “1698”	Clear
9–16	Beards were out. Men who kept one could pay a tax and carry a token as proof.	Re-creation: token passed hand to hand	⏸ Pause after “Beards were out”	Dry
16–23	Prices reportedly varied by rank, with wealthy merchants paying far more than others.	Simple chart: rank vs price, no numbers	▶ New card per sentence	Curious
23–30 CTA	Would you pay to keep your beard, or shave it?	Token spins, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Peter I” entry · State Historical Museum, Moscow: beard tax token
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the beard token and reveal its purpose after a pause.
2. Compare it with Britain’s window tax as a second odd tax.
3. Ask viewers which modern habit they would never pay to keep.

Ready to post

TITLE Peter the Great Taxed Beards

DESCRIPTION Why Russian men once carried a token to keep their beards.

HASHTAGS #history #russianhistory #oddlaws

COVER TEXT Pay to keep it

PIN What is the strangest tax you have heard of?

The Great Fire of London Began in a Bakery

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 1666, a small bakery fire swallowed London.	Period painting of the Great Fire (public domain)	▶ Big card: 1666	Urgent
3–9	It began early on September 2 in Thomas Farriner's bakery on Pudding Lane.	Old London street map, pin on Pudding Lane	Label "Pudding Lane"	Storyteller
9–16	Strong winds and wooden houses let it spread for about four days.	Map: burned area grows	⏸ Pause after "four days"	Tense
16–23	Around 13,000 houses burned. Only a few deaths were recorded, but the true number is unknown.	Timeline graphic: day 1 to day 4	Highlight "unknown"	Careful
23–30 CTA	London rebuilt in brick and stone. Should I cover how they rebuilt it?	Engraving of rebuilt London (public domain)	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Museum of London: Great Fire of London 1666 · Britannica "Great Fire of London"

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Only six people died in the Great Fire. **Documented:** Only a handful of deaths were recorded; the real toll is unknown and may be higher.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the Monument column and explain why it is that tall.
2. Focus on the firebreaks: houses pulled down to stop the spread.
3. Ask viewers which disaster changed their own city.

Ready to post

TITLE The Great Fire of London Began in a Bakery

DESCRIPTION How a bakery fire on Pudding Lane reshaped London in 1666.

HASHTAGS #history #london #greatfire

COVER TEXT It started in a bakery

PIN Which city disaster should I explain next?

Did Medieval People Only Drink Beer?

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Medieval people drank water too. Here's the real story.	Period painting of a village well (public domain)	▶ Big card: WATER TOO	Confident
3–9	The popular version says water was so dirty that everyone drank beer all day.	Re-creation: beer mugs, red question mark	⏸ Pause after "all day"	Teasing
9–16	Written sources mention wells, springs and water carriers. People knew which sources were clean.	Manuscript illustration of a water carrier	▶ New card per sentence	Calm
16–23	Weak ale, often called small beer, was common too. It was cheap calories as much as a drink.	Simple re-creation: bread loaf beside ale	Highlight "small beer"	Explaining
23–30 CTA	So both are true, just not the myth. What other food fact should I check?	Well painting, slow zoom out	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Ale" and "Beer" entries · English Heritage: medieval food and drink
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** Medieval people drank only beer because all water was unsafe. **Documented:** Water was drunk too; weak ale was a common everyday drink and food source.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Focus on monasteries, which brewed their own ale.
2. Compare small beer with today's low-alcohol drinks.
3. Ask viewers what everyday drink their grandparents remember.

Ready to post

TITLE Did Medieval People Only Drink Beer?

DESCRIPTION The truth about water, ale and the medieval "only beer" story.

HASHTAGS `#history #medieval #mythbusting`

COVER TEXT Water? Yes, really

PIN Which food myth should I check next?

The Lost Colony and One Carved Word

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	An entire English colony vanished, leaving one carved word.	Old engraving of Roanoke Island (public domain)	▶ Big card: ONE WORD	Mysterious
3–9	In 1587, about 115 settlers arrived on Roanoke Island, in today's North Carolina.	Map pin on Roanoke Island	Label "1587"	Storyteller
9–16	Their governor, John White, sailed to England for supplies. War delayed his return for three years.	Map: ship icon crosses Atlantic and back	⏸ Pause after "three years"	Steady
16–23	In 1590 the houses were gone. 'CROATOAN' was carved on a post, the name of a nearby island.	Re-creation: carved letters on wood	Highlight "CROATOAN"	Hushed
23–30 CTA	What happened to them is still debated. What do you think happened?	Slow zoom on the carved word	Hold question 1.5 s	Curious

VERIFY WITH	National Park Service: Fort Raleigh National Historic Site · Britannica "Lost Colony"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the word CROATOAN carved on the post.
2. Tell it from John White's view as he lands in 1590.
3. Ask viewers which theory they find most likely.

Ready to post

TITLE The Lost Colony and One Carved Word

DESCRIPTION The Roanoke colonists vanished, leaving one carved word behind.

HASHTAGS #history #unsolved #roanoke

COVER TEXT One word left

PIN Which unsolved history mystery should I cover next?

Rome Taxed the Urine Collected by Laundries

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Ancient Rome taxed urine. And laundries wanted it.	Ancient wall painting of a laundry (public domain)	▶ Big card: TAXED	Playful
3–9	Roman cloth workers, called fullers, used urine to clean and soften wool clothes.	Re-creation: tub, cloth, worker silhouette	Label “fullers”	Explaining
9–16	The ammonia in it helped lift dirt and grease. Jars were collected from public places.	Simple diagram: jar on a street corner	⏸ Pause after “grease”	Matter-of-fact
16–23	Emperor Vespasian placed a tax on this trade, so even waste brought money in.	Ancient coin of Vespasian, museum open-access photo	Highlight “Vespasian”	Wry
23–30 CTA	Weird, but it worked. Which ancient job would you refuse to do?	Laundry painting, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Vespasian” entry and “fulling” in “Textile” coverage
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on a public jar left on a Roman street corner.
2. Focus on Vespasian’s tax and why it was easy to collect.
3. Ask viewers which modern product used to be made strangely.

Ready to post

TITLE Rome Taxed the Urine Collected by Laundries

DESCRIPTION Why Roman laundries collected urine, and the emperor taxed it.

HASHTAGS #history #ancientrome #oddhistory

COVER TEXT They taxed WHAT?

PIN What other ancient job should I cover?

The Bayeux Tapestry Isn't a Tapestry

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	The Bayeux Tapestry isn't really a tapestry.	Public-domain photo of the Bayeux embroidery	▶ Big card: NOT A TAPESTRY	Confident
3–9	A tapestry is woven on a loom. This one is embroidered: wool stitched onto linen.	Diagram: weave vs stitch	▶ New card per sentence	Explaining
9–16	It tells the story of the Norman conquest of England in 1066, scene by scene.	Panel close-ups, slow pan	Label "1066"	Storyteller
16–23	It is about 70 metres long and was probably made within a few years of 1066.	Timeline graphic: 1066 → 1070s	Highlight "70 metres"	Amazed
23–30 CTA	Same story, wrong name. Which famous object has a misleading name?	Slow pan along the panels	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Bayeux Museum: the Bayeux Tapestry · Britannica "Bayeux Tapestry"
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** The Bayeux Tapestry is a woven tapestry. **Documented:** It is embroidery: woollen thread stitched onto linen, not woven.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a close-up of the stitches, then pull back to its length.
2. Compare its length to something local, like a swimming pool.
3. Ask viewers which famous artwork has a misleading name.

Ready to post

TITLE The Bayeux Tapestry Isn't a Tapestry

DESCRIPTION The famous 1066 artwork is embroidery, not a tapestry.

HASHTAGS #history #medieval #1066

COVER TEXT Not a tapestry

PIN Which famous object should I explain next?

The Clock That Helped Ships Find Longitude

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Ships got lost because no clock worked at sea.	Old sea chart (public domain)	▶ Big card: LOST AT SEA	Serious
3–9	Sailors could find latitude from the sun, but longitude needed exact time.	Diagram: latitude vs longitude lines	❚❚ Pause after “exact time”	Explaining
9–16	Pendulum clocks failed on rolling ships. Britain offered a large prize in 1714 for a solution.	Timeline graphic: 1714 prize	Label “1714”	Building
16–23	Carpenter turned clockmaker John Harrison built several sea clocks. His watch H4 passed a voyage test.	Museum photo of H4, open-access	Highlight “H4”	Proud
23–30 CTA	A pocket watch solved it. What invention do you think saved more sailors?	Slow zoom on H4 dial	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Royal Museums Greenwich: John Harrison and the longitude problem · Britannica “John Harrison”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the H4 watch and its size in a hand.
2. Focus on the 1714 prize that started the race.
3. Ask viewers which invention they think saved the most lives at sea.

Ready to post

TITLE The Clock That Helped Ships Find Longitude

DESCRIPTION How John Harrison’s sea clock helped sailors find longitude.

HASHTAGS #history #navigation #inventions

COVER TEXT A clock saved ships

PIN Which navigation invention should I explain next?

Ben Franklin's Kite Wasn't Struck by Lightning

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Lightning never struck Ben Franklin's kite.	Period painting of Franklin's kite (public domain)	▶ Big card: NO STRIKE	Confident
3–9	Franklin described flying a kite in a storm in 1752, with a metal key tied on.	Re-creation: kite, string, key	Label "1752"	Storyteller
9–16	Electric charge from the storm clouds collected on the wet string and the key. He felt sparks.	Diagram: charge travels down the string	⏸ Pause after "sparks"	Explaining
16–23	A direct strike would likely have killed him. The point was to show lightning is electricity.	Simple graphic: cloud equals spark	Highlight "electricity"	Serious
23–30 CTA	It led to the lightning rod. Which experiment would you want to watch live?	Lightning rod sketch, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Franklin Institute, Philadelphia: Franklin's kite experiment · Britannica "Benjamin Franklin"
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** Lightning struck Franklin's kite directly. **Documented:** Franklin described collecting electric charge from storm clouds; a direct strike would likely have killed him.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the key and explain why it mattered.
2. Focus on lightning rods, the practical result of the experiment.
3. Ask viewers what experiment they wish they could watch.

Ready to post

TITLE Ben Franklin's Kite Wasn't Struck by Lightning

DESCRIPTION What Franklin's 1752 kite experiment really showed.

HASHTAGS #history #science #benfranklin

COVER TEXT No lightning strike

PIN Which science myth should I check next?

England Had Laws About Who Could Wear Purple

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 · 3 · 9 · 16 · 23 · 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In Tudor England, purple silk was off-limits to most.	Tudor portrait in rich fabric (public domain)	▶ Big card: OFF-LIMITS	Intrigued
3–9	Laws called statutes of apparel set what each rank was allowed to wear.	Re-creation: ranking ladder with fabric icons	Label “statutes of apparel”	Explaining
9–16	Purple silk was for the royal family. Some furs, velvets and gold cloth needed high rank.	Fabric swatch graphic	▶ New card per sentence	Clear
16–23	The goal was to keep social ranks visible at a glance, and to limit spending on imports.	Simple graphic: crowd sorted by color	❚❚ Pause after “at a glance”	Thoughtful
23–30 CTA	Clothes showed your place. Which of your clothes would the Tudors ban?	Portrait slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Sumptuary law” entry · The National Archives (UK): Tudor statutes of apparel
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Focus on one fabric, like velvet or cloth of gold.
2. Compare the rules with today’s school or work dress codes.
3. Ask viewers which item they would be banned from wearing.

Ready to post

TITLE England Had Laws About Who Could Wear Purple

DESCRIPTION Tudor clothing laws decided who could wear which colours and fabrics.

HASHTAGS #history #tudors #oddlaws

COVER TEXT Purple? Not for you

PIN What other strange law should I explain?

The Night the Berlin Wall Opened

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	On November 9, 1989, a wall opened overnight.	Map of divided Berlin (self-made)	▶ Big card: NOV 9, 1989	Urgent
3–9	Since 1961, the Berlin Wall had split the city into East and West.	Timeline graphic: 1961 → 1989	Label “1961”	Steady
9–16	That evening, a confused announcement suggested new travel rules started immediately.	Re-creation: microphone, paper notes	⏸ Pause after “immediately”	Tense
16–23	Crowds gathered at the crossings, and the guards opened the gates. Demolition came later, in 1990.	Map: crossing points light up	Highlight “opened the gates”	Moving
23–30 CTA	One night changed a city. Which turning-point day should I tell next?	Slow zoom on the map	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Berlin Wall” entry · Berlin Wall Memorial (Gedenkstätte Berliner Mauer)

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** The Berlin Wall was torn down on the night of November 9, 1989. **Documented:** That night the crossings opened; official demolition began in 1990.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the date and a map of the divided city.
2. Focus on the press-conference mix-up that started the rush.
3. Ask viewers which date they would add to a history calendar.

Ready to post

TITLE The Night the Berlin Wall Opened

DESCRIPTION November 9, 1989: the night the Berlin border crossings opened.

HASHTAGS #history #berlinwall #thisdate

COVER TEXT The gates opened

PIN Which turning-point day should I cover next?

Knocker-Uppers: Alarm Clocks With a Long Stick

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Before alarm clocks, people paid someone to wake them.	Re-creation silhouette: figure with a long pole	▶ Big card: HUMAN ALARM	Playful
3–9	In industrial British towns, mill and factory shifts started early, before sunrise.	Period painting of a mill town (public domain)	Label “before sunrise”	Clear
9–16	A knocker-upper walked the streets with a long pole and tapped on upstairs windows.	Re-creation: pole taps a window	❚❚ Pause after “windows”	Storyteller
16–23	They stayed until someone answered, then moved to the next house on the list.	Simple map: route of houses	▶ New card per sentence	Fun
23–30 CTA	The job faded as alarm clocks got cheaper. How do you make sure you wake up?	Window lights up, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Industrial Revolution” coverage · Science and Industry Museum, Manchester
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the long pole tapping a bedroom window.
2. Mention pea-shooters, a tool some knocker-uppers reportedly used.
3. Ask viewers how they wake up on time.

Ready to post

TITLE Knocker-Uppers: Alarm Clocks With a Long Stick

DESCRIPTION Before cheap alarm clocks, people paid someone to wake them.

HASHTAGS #history #oddjobs #victorian

COVER TEXT A human alarm clock

PIN Which old job should I explain next?

The Library of Alexandria Didn't Burn in One Night

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)



TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	The Library of Alexandria didn't vanish in one fire.	Old engraving of the library (public domain)	▶ Big card: NOT ONE FIRE	Confident
3–9	The popular version says one huge blaze wiped out the ancient world's knowledge.	Re-creation: scrolls in flames, red question mark	❚❚ Pause after "knowledge"	Teasing
9–16	A fire around 48 BC may have damaged part of the collection. The library continued afterward.	Timeline graphic: 48 BC marker	Highlight "continued"	Explaining
16–23	Over centuries it lost funding, scholars and protection, and slowly declined.	Timeline graphic: slow fade to grey	▶ New card per sentence	Thoughtful
23–30 CTA	A slow fade, not one fire. Which lost book would you bring back?	Engraving, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Library of Alexandria" entry

MYTH CHECK

Popular version: The Library of Alexandria was destroyed in one great fire.
Documented: It declined over centuries through funding cuts, conflict and neglect; no single fire ended it.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on what it collected: ships searched for scrolls to copy.
2. Focus on the fire of 48 BC and why it wasn't the end.
3. Ask viewers which lost book they would bring back.

Ready to post

TITLE The Library of Alexandria Didn't Burn in One Night

DESCRIPTION Why the Library of Alexandria faded instead of burning in one night.

HASHTAGS #history #ancient #mythbusting

COVER TEXT It faded slowly

PIN Which lost library or book should I cover next?

You Can’t See the Great Wall From the Moon

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	You can’t see the Great Wall from the Moon.	Photo of the Great Wall, open-licence	▶ Big card: NOT VISIBLE	Confident
3–9	The wall is very long, but most sections are only a few metres wide.	Diagram: wall width vs length	Highlight “few metres”	Explaining
9–16	From the Moon, about 384,000 kilometres away, that is like spotting a hair from kilometres off.	Simple graphic: Earth from the Moon	⏸ Pause after “away”	Amazed
16–23	Astronauts in low orbit have said it is very hard to spot without help.	Public-domain NASA image of Earth	▶ New card per sentence	Calm
23–30 CTA	Huge, but thin. What other space myth have you heard?	Wall photo, slow zoom out	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	NASA Earth Observatory: Great Wall from space · Britannica “Great Wall of China”
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** The Great Wall is the only human-made structure visible from the Moon. **Documented:** It is far too narrow to see with the naked eye from the Moon.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Compare the wall’s width to a two-lane road.
2. Focus on the Ming dynasty, when most of today’s wall was built.
3. Ask viewers which other space myth they have heard.

Ready to post

TITLE You Can’t See the Great Wall From the Moon

DESCRIPTION Why the Great Wall can’t be seen from the Moon.

HASHTAGS `#history #greatwall #mythbusting`

COVER TEXT Not from the Moon

PIN What other ‘visible from space’ claim should I check?

Cologne Cathedral Took Over 600 Years to Finish

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	This cathedral took over six hundred years to finish.	Photo of Cologne Cathedral, open-licence	▶ Big card: 600+ YEARS	Amazed
3–9	Work on Cologne Cathedral in Germany started in 1248, in the Gothic style.	Timeline graphic: 1248 marker	Label “1248”	Storyteller
9–16	Around the 1470s, building stopped. A medieval crane stayed on the unfinished tower for centuries.	Old engraving of the crane on the tower (public domain)	⏸ Pause after “stopped”	Curious
16–23	In the 1800s, workers used the original medieval plans to complete it. It was finished in 1880.	Timeline graphic: 1248 → 1880	Highlight “1880”	Reveal
23–30 CTA	Six centuries for one building. What took you the longest to finish?	Slow pan up the towers	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	UNESCO World Heritage Centre: Cologne Cathedral · Britannica “Cologne Cathedral”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the crane that stood on the unfinished tower for centuries.
2. Compare the build time with the age of your own country.
3. Ask viewers what took them the longest to finish.

Ready to post

TITLE Cologne Cathedral Took Over 600 Years to Finish

DESCRIPTION The cathedral that took more than six centuries to complete.

HASHTAGS #history #medieval #architecture

COVER TEXT 632 years to build

PIN Which building should I cover next?

Vikings Reached America 500 Years Before Columbus

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Vikings reached North America almost 500 years before Columbus.	Map: North Atlantic route, Greenland to Newfoundland	▶ Big card: 500 YEARS EARLIER	Bold
3–9	Old Norse sagas described a land called Vinland, west of Greenland.	Manuscript page photo, museum open-access	Label “Vinland”	Storyteller
9–16	In the 1960s, archaeologists dug at L’Anse aux Meadows in Newfoundland, Canada.	Map pin on Newfoundland	⏸ Pause after “Canada”	Curious
16–23	They found Norse-style buildings and objects from around the year 1000. The stay was short.	Photo of rebuilt turf houses, open-licence	Highlight “year 1000”	Reveal
23–30 CTA	So Columbus wasn’t first. Which history ‘first’ do you think is wrong?	Map, slow zoom out	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Parks Canada: L’Anse aux Meadows National Historic Site · UNESCO World Heritage Centre
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** Columbus was the first European to reach the Americas. **Documented:** Norse Vikings settled briefly at L’Anse aux Meadows around 1000, almost 500 years earlier.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the turf houses rebuilt at the site today.
2. Focus on the Norse sagas that described Vinland.
3. Ask viewers which history ‘first’ they think is wrong.

Ready to post

TITLE Vikings Reached America 500 Years Before Columbus

DESCRIPTION The Norse site in Newfoundland that predates Columbus by centuries.

HASHTAGS #history #vikings #exploration

COVER TEXT Vikings got there first

PIN Which other history ‘first’ should I check?

Ada Lovelace Wrote About Computers in 1843

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 9 16 23 30

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	The first computer program was written in 1843.	Period portrait of Ada Lovelace (public domain)	▶ Big card: 1843	Intrigued
3–9	Charles Babbage designed the Analytical Engine, a mechanical calculator that was never finished.	Museum photo of Babbage's engine parts, open-access	Label "Analytical Engine"	Explaining
9–16	Ada Lovelace translated an article about it and added notes longer than the article itself.	Re-creation: two paper stacks, hers taller	⏸ Pause after "itself"	Storyteller
16–23	One note set out steps for the machine to calculate a sequence of numbers.	Simple graphic: table of steps	Highlight "steps"	Clear
23–30 CTA	She also guessed machines could do more than math. Who should I cover next?	Portrait, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Science Museum, London: Charles Babbage's Analytical Engine · Britannica "Ada Lovelace"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on Note G, the famous table in her notes.
2. Focus on her idea that machines could handle music, not just numbers.
3. Ask viewers who they think was the first programmer.

Ready to post

TITLE Ada Lovelace Wrote About Computers in 1843

DESCRIPTION How Ada Lovelace described programming a machine never built.

HASHTAGS #history #science #adalovelace

COVER TEXT Code in 1843

PIN Which science pioneer should I cover next?

When Europe Put Pigs on Trial

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	European courts once put pigs on trial. Really.	Medieval manuscript image of a courtroom (public domain)	▶ Big card: ON TRIAL	Playful
3–10	From roughly the 1300s to the 1700s, records describe animals charged in courts across Europe.	Map of Europe with case pins	Label "1300s–1700s"	Clear
10–18	Pigs were common defendants, usually for causing harm on farms. Some cases had a formal hearing and a verdict.	Re-creation: pig silhouette in a dock	❚❚ Pause after "farms"	Matter-of-fact
18–27	Church courts handled pests too. Rats and insects that ate crops were sometimes formally warned to leave.	Manuscript margin drawing of insects (public domain)	▶ New card per sentence	Wry
27–36	Historians link these trials to ideas about order and justice: even harm by an animal needed a public answer.	Simple graphic: scales of justice	Highlight "public answer"	Thoughtful
36–45 CTA	A collection of cases was published in 1906. Which animal would you put on trial today?	Courtroom image, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	E. P. Evans, The Criminal Prosecution and Capital Punishment of Animals (1906) · Britannica "animal trial"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Focus on insect cases, where church courts warned pests to leave fields.
2. Open on the 1386 Falaise case and its reported clothing detail.
3. Ask viewers which animal they would put on trial today.

Ready to post

TITLE When Europe Put Pigs on Trial

DESCRIPTION Real medieval and early modern court cases against animals.

HASHTAGS `#history #oddlaws #medieval`

COVER TEXT The pig had a lawyer

PIN What strange court case should I cover next?

The First Powered Flight Lasted 12 Seconds

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	The first powered flight lasted only twelve seconds.	Public-domain photo of the 1903 Wright Flyer	▶ Big card: 12 SECONDS	Amazed
3–10	On December 17, 1903, Orville and Wilbur Wright tested their engine-powered Flyer near Kitty Hawk.	Map pin on Kitty Hawk, North Carolina	Label “Dec 17, 1903”	Storyteller
10–18	Orville flew first. The plane covered about 120 feet, less than the wingspan of a large jet.	Diagram: 120 feet vs jet wingspan	Highlight “120 feet”	Building
18–27	They flew four times that day. The longest flight, by Wilbur, lasted about 59 seconds.	Timeline graphic: four flights, durations	▶ New card per flight	Clear
27–36	A gust of wind then damaged the plane, and it never flew again. It is now in a museum.	Museum photo of the Flyer, open-access	⏸ Pause after “never flew again”	Reflective
36–45 CTA	Sixty-six years later, people walked on the Moon. What invention do you think moved fastest?	Timeline: 1903 → 1969	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum: the 1903 Wright Flyer · Britannica “Wright brothers”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the famous photo taken at the moment of liftoff.
2. Focus on the fourth flight of the day, the longest one.
3. Ask viewers how far they think aviation came in 66 years.

Ready to post

TITLE The First Powered Flight Lasted 12 Seconds

DESCRIPTION The 12-second flight at Kitty Hawk that started powered aviation.

HASHTAGS #history #aviation #wrightbrothers

COVER TEXT 12 seconds

PIN Which invention day should I cover next?

The Man Who Shipped Ice Around the World

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Ice from frozen ponds once sailed to the tropics.	Period engraving of ice harvesting (public domain)	▶ Big card: ICE BY SHIP	Intrigued
3–10	In 1806, a Boston merchant named Frederic Tudor shipped ice to the Caribbean. People laughed at him.	Map: Boston to the Caribbean	Label “1806”	Storyteller
10–18	Workers sawed blocks from frozen ponds in winter and packed them in sawdust to slow the melting.	Re-creation: ice blocks stacked in sawdust	❚❚ Pause after “sawdust”	Explaining
18–27	Tudor built insulated ice houses at the ports. Over the years his ice trade became profitable.	Simple diagram: ice house walls	▶ New card per sentence	Steady
27–36	By the 1830s, ships even carried New England ice to India, a voyage of several months.	Map: route around Africa to India	Highlight “India”	Amazed
36–45 CTA	Ice was once a luxury import. Which everyday item do you think was once a luxury?	Engraving, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Frederic Tudor” entry · Massachusetts Historical Society: Tudor Ice Company papers
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on ice blocks sawn from a frozen pond in winter.
2. Focus on the long voyage to India and the sawdust insulation.
3. Ask viewers what everyday item they think was once a luxury.

Ready to post

TITLE The Man Who Shipped Ice Around the World

DESCRIPTION How frozen New England ponds supplied ice to the tropics.

HASHTAGS #history #everydayhistory #inventions

COVER TEXT Ice in the tropics

PIN What everyday item should I trace next?

The Voynich Manuscript Nobody Can Read

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Six centuries old, and nobody can read this book.	Public-domain scan of a Voynich manuscript page	▶ Big card: UNREADABLE	Mysterious
3–10	It is called the Voynich manuscript, after a book dealer who bought it in 1912.	Label graphic: MS 408, Yale	Label “1912”	Storyteller
10–18	Its vellum pages were radiocarbon dated to the early 1400s. They hold about 240 pages of unknown script.	Timeline graphic: early 1400s marker	Highlight “unknown script”	Curious
18–27	There are drawings of plants nobody has identified, star charts and bathing figures. Some pages fold out.	Slow pan over drawings (public domain scans)	▶ New card per item	Hushed
27–36	Professional code-breakers and many researchers have tried. No proposed reading has been widely accepted.	Re-creation: notes and crossed-out guesses	⏸ Pause after “tried”	Serious
36–45 CTA	It sits at Yale today. Is it a code, a lost language, or a hoax?	Page scan, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Curious

VERIFY WITH	Beinecke Rare Book & Manuscript Library, Yale University: MS 408 · Britannica “Voynich manuscript”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on one of the strange plant drawings.
2. Focus on the code-breakers who tried and failed to read it.
3. Ask viewers whether they think it is a code, a language or a hoax.

Ready to post

TITLE The Voynich Manuscript Nobody Can Read

DESCRIPTION A 600-year-old book written in a script nobody has deciphered.

HASHTAGS #history #unsolved #voynich

COVER TEXT Nobody can read it

PIN Which historical mystery should I cover next?

The Pyramid Builders Weren't Slaves

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	The pyramids weren't built by slaves. Here's the evidence.	Photo of the Giza pyramids, open-licence	▶ Big card: NOT SLAVES	Confident
3–10	The popular version shows whipped slaves dragging stones. It spread through old histories and films.	Re-creation: red question mark over the scene	❚❚ Pause after "films"	Teasing
10–18	Archaeologists found a workers' town near Giza, with bakeries, sleeping halls and many animal bones from food.	Map: workers' town beside the pyramids	Highlight "workers' town"	Explaining
18–27	They also found workers' tombs close to the pyramids. Enslaved people would not usually get such burials.	Photo of tomb remains, open-licence	▶ New card per sentence	Calm
27–36	The likely picture is skilled crews plus rotating labourers called up for a season, paid partly in food.	Simple graphic: crew rotation diagram	❚❚ Pause after "season"	Thoughtful
36–45 CTA	Hard work, but not slavery as shown in films. What ancient myth should I check next?	Pyramids at sunset, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Pyramids of Giza" entry · Ancient Egypt Research Associates: Giza workers' town

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Slaves built the pyramids. **Documented:** Evidence points to paid and conscripted Egyptian workers who lived in a nearby town and had their own tombs.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the workers' tombs found near the pyramids.
2. Focus on food: bread, beer and meat in the workers' town.
3. Ask viewers where they first heard the slave version.

Ready to post

TITLE The Pyramid Builders Weren't Slaves

DESCRIPTION What archaeology shows about who really built the Giza pyramids.

HASHTAGS #history #ancientegypt #mythbusting

COVER TEXT Not slaves

PIN Which ancient myth should I check next?

Did Medieval People Really Die at 30?

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Medieval people didn't all die at thirty. Averages mislead.	Medieval painting of elderly villagers (public domain)	▶ Big card: NOT 30	Confident
3–10	You may have heard that medieval life expectancy was around 30, so adults died young.	Re-creation: number 30 with red question mark	⏸ Pause after "young"	Teasing
10–18	But an average includes babies and children. Many children died very young, which pulls the average far down.	Simple chart: ages spread, average line drops	Highlight "includes babies"	Explaining
18–27	If you survived childhood, your chances changed. Many adults lived into their fifties or sixties, some much longer.	Chart: adult ages shift right	▶ New card per sentence	Calm
27–36	So 30 was the average at birth, not a typical age of death for grown adults.	Timeline graphic: birth → adulthood	⏸ Pause after "at birth"	Clear
36–45 CTA	One number, two meanings. What history statistic confused you as a kid?	Painting, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Life expectancy" entry · Our World in Data: life expectancy (historical)

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Medieval adults usually died around age 30. **Documented:** Low averages come mostly from child deaths; adults who survived childhood often lived into their 50s or 60s.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Use a simple class of ten children to show how averages work.
2. Name a famous medieval writer who lived past 60.
3. Ask viewers what history number they misread as a kid.

Ready to post

TITLE Did Medieval People Really Die at 30?

DESCRIPTION Why a low medieval life expectancy doesn't mean everyone died young.

HASHTAGS #history #medieval #mythbusting

COVER TEXT Not dead at 30

PIN Which history number should I explain next?

China's Treasure Fleets Sailed Before Columbus

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Decades before Columbus, Chinese fleets reached East Africa.	Old map of the Indian Ocean (public domain)	▶ Big card: BEFORE COLUMBUS	Bold
3–10	Between 1405 and 1433, the admiral Zheng He led seven great voyages for the Ming emperors.	Timeline graphic: seven voyage markers	Label "1405–1433"	Storyteller
10–18	The fleets were huge. The first reportedly carried around 27,000 people on many ships.	Simple graphic: fleet of ship icons	Highlight "27,000"	Amazed
18–27	They sailed to Southeast Asia, India, Arabia and the coast of East Africa, trading and showing Ming power.	Map: routes across the Indian Ocean	▶ New card per region	Steady
27–36	The exact size of the biggest ships is debated. Some accounts may exaggerate them.	Re-creation: ship outline with question mark	⏸ Pause after "debated"	Careful
36–45 CTA	After 1433 the voyages stopped, and the fleets were never sent again. Why do you think China ended them?	Map, slow zoom out	Hold question 1.5 s	Curious

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Zheng He" entry · National Museum of China
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a giraffe brought back to the Ming court.
2. Focus on why China stopped the voyages after 1433.
3. Ask viewers which explorer they think deserves more fame.

Ready to post

TITLE China's Treasure Fleets Sailed Before Columbus

DESCRIPTION Zheng He's Ming fleets reached East Africa decades before Columbus.

HASHTAGS #history #exploration #zhenghe

COVER TEXT Fleets before Columbus

PIN Which explorer should I cover next?

The First Long-Distance Telegraph Message

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 1844, a message crossed forty miles almost instantly.	Public-domain photo of a Morse telegraph key	▶ Big card: INSTANT	Amazed
3–10	Before that, news traveled as fast as a horse, a train or a ship could carry it.	Re-creation: horse, train and ship icons	❚❚ Pause after “carry it”	Clear
10–18	Samuel Morse and his partners built a telegraph line from Washington to Baltimore, about 40 miles.	Map: line between the two cities	Label “about 40 miles”	Storyteller
18–27	On May 24, 1844, Morse tapped out a Bible phrase: what hath God wrought. It arrived in Baltimore.	Paper tape graphic with dots and dashes	Highlight the message	Moving
27–36	Within a few decades, telegraph wires crossed continents and, from 1866, the Atlantic Ocean.	Map: wires spread across continents	▶ New card per date	Building
36–45 CTA	Words at the speed of electricity. What would your first message be?	Telegraph key, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Library of Congress: Samuel F. B. Morse Papers · Britannica “Samuel F. B. Morse”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the paper tape that recorded the first message.
2. Focus on Alfred Vail, who helped build the system.
3. Ask viewers what message they would send first.

Ready to post

TITLE The First Long-Distance Telegraph Message

DESCRIPTION How the first official telegraph message crossed 40 miles instantly.

HASHTAGS #history #inventions #telegraph

COVER TEXT 40 miles. Instantly.

PIN Which communication invention should I cover next?

Britain's Tax on Windows

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 — 3 — 10 — 18 — 27 — 36 — 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Britain once taxed people for their windows.	Photo of a bricked-up window, own photo or open-licence	▶ Big card: WINDOW TAX	Playful
3–10	In 1696, England introduced a window tax. Houses with more windows paid more.	Timeline graphic: 1696 marker	Label "1696"	Clear
10–18	The idea was simple. Windows could be counted from the street, so officials didn't need to go inside.	Re-creation: official counting windows	⏸ Pause after "simple"	Explaining
18–27	Many owners bricked up windows to pay less. You can still see blocked windows on some old buildings.	Photo series of blocked windows	▶ New card per sentence	Wry
27–36	Critics said it cut light and fresh air in crowded homes. The tax was finally abolished in 1851.	Timeline graphic: 1696 → 1851	Highlight "1851"	Serious
36–45 CTA	It lasted 155 years. Have you ever spotted a bricked-up window near you?	Slow zoom on the blocked window	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	The National Archives (UK): window tax records · Britannica "window tax"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a bricked-up window on an old building near you.
2. Compare the window tax with a modern property tax.
3. Ask viewers to spot bricked-up windows on their street.

Ready to post

TITLE Britain's Tax on Windows

DESCRIPTION The tax that made people brick up their windows for 155 years.

HASHTAGS #history #oddlaws #britishhistory

COVER TEXT Windows were taxed

PIN Which odd tax should I cover next?

The Year Britain Skipped 11 Days

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 1752, Britain skipped eleven days in one night.	Re-creation: calendar page, Sept 3–13 crossed out	▶ Big card: 11 DAYS GONE	Intrigued
3–10	The old Julian calendar ran a little long, so it slowly drifted away from the seasons.	Diagram: calendar vs sun drift	❚❚ Pause after “seasons”	Explaining
10–18	Catholic countries had switched to the Gregorian calendar in 1582. Britain waited about 170 years.	Timeline graphic: 1582 → 1752	Label “170 years”	Clear
18–27	To catch up, Wednesday, September 2, 1752 was followed by Thursday, September 14. The days between never happened.	Calendar graphic: 2 jumps to 14	Highlight “September 14”	Amazed
27–36	There’s a famous story about riots demanding the lost days back. Evidence for real riots is thin.	Re-creation: crowd with red question mark	❚❚ Pause after “thin”	Careful
36–45 CTA	The same change reached the American colonies. Which day would you happily skip?	Calendar page, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	Royal Museums Greenwich: the 1752 calendar change · Britannica “Gregorian calendar”
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** Crowds rioted shouting ‘Give us our eleven days!’ **Documented:** Reports of such riots are thin; historians trace the story mainly to an election satire.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on a calendar page for September 1752.
2. Focus on the 1582 Catholic switch, 170 years earlier.
3. Ask viewers which day they would skip.

Ready to post

TITLE The Year Britain Skipped 11 Days

DESCRIPTION Why September 1752 is missing 11 days in Britain.

HASHTAGS #history #calendar #thisdate

COVER TEXT 11 days vanished

PIN Which calendar oddity should I explain next?

The Dogs That Turned the Roast

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Kitchens once used small dogs to turn the roast.	Period illustration of a turnspit wheel (public domain)	▶ Big card: DOG POWER	Playful
3–10	Meat was roasted on a spit in front of the fire, and it had to keep turning.	Re-creation: spit in front of a fireplace	❚❚ Pause after "turning"	Clear
10–18	In many British kitchens, a small breed called the turnspit dog ran inside a wooden wheel on the wall.	Diagram: wheel linked to spit by a belt	Label "turnspit dog"	Storyteller
18–27	The wheel was linked to the spit, so as the dog ran, the meat turned. Shifts could be long.	Simple animation: wheel turns, spit turns	▶ New card per sentence	Matter-of-fact
27–36	Mechanical spits replaced them in the 1800s, and the breed died out. A preserved one is in a Welsh museum.	Timeline graphic: 1500s → 1800s	Highlight "died out"	Reflective
36–45 CTA	A whole breed gone with one job. Which old job should I explain next?	Illustration, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: "turnspit" entry · Abergavenny Museum, Wales: the turnspit dog Whiskey
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the wooden wheel mounted high on a kitchen wall.
2. Focus on the preserved dog at Abergavenny Museum.
3. Ask viewers which job a machine replaced in their family.

Ready to post

TITLE The Dogs That Turned the Roast

DESCRIPTION Small dogs once ran in wall wheels to turn kitchen roasts.

HASHTAGS #history #dogs #everydayhistory

COVER TEXT A dog-powered kitchen

PIN Which forgotten job should I cover next?

Amelia Earhart's Last Flight

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Amelia Earhart vanished in 1937. Nobody found her plane.	Public-domain photo of Earhart's Lockheed Electra	▶ Big card: NEVER FOUND	Serious
3–10	Earhart was famous already. In 1932 she became the first woman to fly solo across the Atlantic.	Map: Atlantic route	Label "1932"	Storyteller
10–18	In 1937, she and navigator Fred Noonan set out to fly around the world near the equator.	Map: round-the-world route	Highlight "around the world"	Building
18–27	On July 2, they left New Guinea for Howland Island, a tiny speck in the Pacific. They never arrived.	Map: route ends before Howland Island	⏸ Pause after "never arrived"	Hushed
27–36	A huge search found nothing. Theories include running out of fuel at sea or landing on another island.	Re-creation: search ships on a map	▶ New card per theory	Careful
36–45 CTA	None has been proven. What do you think happened on that last flight?	Slow zoom on the empty ocean	Hold question 1.5 s	Curious

VERIFY WITH	Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum: Amelia Earhart · Britannica "Amelia Earhart"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on Howland Island, the tiny target she never reached.
2. Focus on her 1932 solo Atlantic flight before the final trip.
3. Ask viewers which theory they think the evidence supports.

Ready to post

TITLE Amelia Earhart's Last Flight

DESCRIPTION What is known, and not known, about Earhart's disappearance.

HASHTAGS #history #unsolved #aviation

COVER TEXT She never landed

PIN Which aviation mystery should I cover next?

The Roman Dome Still Standing After 1,900 Years

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	This Roman dome has stood for nearly 1,900 years.	Public-domain photo of the Pantheon dome interior	▶ Big card: 1,900 YEARS	Amazed
3–10	The Pantheon in Rome was rebuilt under Emperor Hadrian around AD 125, and it is still in use.	Map pin on Rome	Label “c. AD 125”	Storyteller
10–18	Its dome is about 43 metres across. It has no steel inside: it is unreinforced concrete.	Diagram: dome cross-section with measurement	Highlight “no steel”	Clear
18–27	The builders made the concrete lighter toward the top, using lighter stone mixed in, and thinner walls.	Diagram: heavy at base, light at top	⏸ Pause after “toward the top”	Explaining
27–36	At the very top is an open hole, the oculus, about nine metres wide. Rain falls straight in.	Photo looking up at the oculus	▶ New card per sentence	Calm
36–45 CTA	Still the largest dome of its kind. Which ancient building would you visit first?	Slow zoom on the oculus	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Pantheon” entry · Smarthistory: the Pantheon
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the oculus, the open hole in the top of the dome.
2. Compare the dome with a modern stadium roof.
3. Ask viewers which ancient building they want to visit.

Ready to post

TITLE The Roman Dome Still Standing After 1,900 Years

DESCRIPTION How the Pantheon’s unreinforced concrete dome has lasted so long.

HASHTAGS `#history` `#ancientrome` `#architecture`

COVER TEXT No steel. Still standing.

PIN Which ancient building should I cover next?

Gutenberg's Bible and the Printing Press

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	One workshop in Mainz changed how Europe made books.	Public-domain scan of a Gutenberg Bible page	▶ Big card: MAINZ	Bold
3–10	Before the 1450s, almost every book in Europe was copied by hand, often taking months.	Manuscript illustration of a scribe (public domain)	Label "by hand"	Clear
10–18	Johannes Gutenberg developed a system of movable metal type, oil-based ink and a press adapted from wine presses.	Diagram: type pieces, ink, press	▶ New card per item	Explaining
18–27	Around 1455 his workshop finished a large Latin Bible. Historians estimate about 180 copies were printed.	Timeline graphic: c. 1455 marker	Highlight "about 180 copies"	Storyteller
27–36	Gutenberg lost his workshop to his financial partner after a lawsuit. Printing spread across Europe anyway.	Map: printing spreads city by city	⏸ Pause after "lawsuit"	Reflective
36–45 CTA	Fewer than 50 copies survive today. Which book would you have printed first?	Page scan, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Library of Congress: the Gutenberg Bible · Britannica "Johannes Gutenberg"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a page of the Gutenberg Bible held by a library.
2. Focus on the lawsuit that cost Gutenberg his workshop.
3. Ask viewers which book they would print first.

Ready to post

TITLE Gutenberg's Bible and the Printing Press

DESCRIPTION How movable metal type changed how books were made in Europe.

HASHTAGS #history #printing #medieval

COVER TEXT Books for everyone

PIN Which invention should I cover next?

The Scurvy Experiment That Took Decades to Use

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	On long voyages, sailors feared scurvy more than storms.	Period painting of a sailing warship (public domain)	▶ Big card: SCURVY	Serious
3–10	Scurvy caused weakness and bleeding gums on long voyages. We now know it comes from lacking vitamin C.	Re-creation: ship's biscuit and salt meat	Label "vitamin C"	Explaining
10–18	In 1747, ship's surgeon James Lind tested treatments on twelve sick sailors, in pairs.	Diagram: six pairs, six treatments	Highlight "twelve sailors"	Storyteller
18–27	The pair given oranges and lemons improved fastest. It was one of the earliest controlled trials in medicine.	Diagram: citrus pair highlighted	❚❚ Pause after "fastest"	Building
27–36	But the Navy didn't act at once. Lemon juice became a routine ration only around 1795.	Timeline graphic: 1747 → 1795	▶ New card per date	Reflective
36–45 CTA	Nearly fifty years for a fix. Which good idea do you think took too long?	Lemon crate, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Royal College of Physicians of Edinburgh: James Lind · Britannica "scurvy"

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Lind's 1747 test ended scurvy in the Navy right away. **Documented:** The Royal Navy only issued lemon juice routinely around 1795, decades later.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a crate of lemons on a ship's deck.
2. Focus on why the result was ignored for so long.
3. Ask viewers which good idea they think took too long to catch on.

Ready to post

TITLE The Scurvy Experiment That Took Decades to Use

DESCRIPTION James Lind's 1747 citrus test and why the Navy waited decades.

HASHTAGS #history #science #navy

COVER TEXT Lemons beat scurvy

PIN Which medical history story should I cover next?

The X-Ray of a Hand That Shocked the World

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 1895, a glowing screen led to the X-ray.	Public-domain X-ray image of a hand with a ring	▶ Big card: 1895	Intrigued
3–10	On November 8, Wilhelm Röntgen was testing a covered electric tube in his German lab.	Re-creation: lab bench with a glass tube	Label “Nov 8, 1895”	Storyteller
10–18	A coated screen across the room started to glow, even though the tube was covered.	Diagram: invisible rays reach a screen	❚❚ Pause after “glow”	Curious
18–27	He called the unknown rays X-rays. Weeks later he made an image of his wife’s hand, showing bones and a ring.	Slow zoom on the hand image	Highlight “X-rays”	Amazed
27–36	Doctors began using X-rays within months. In 1901 Röntgen received the first Nobel Prize in Physics.	Timeline graphic: 1895 → 1901	▶ New card per date	Proud
36–45 CTA	An accident changed medicine. Which accidental discovery surprises you most?	Hand X-ray, slow zoom out	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Deutsches Röntgen-Museum, Remscheid · Britannica “Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the 1895 X-ray image of a hand with a ring.
2. Focus on how fast doctors started using X-rays in 1896.
3. Ask viewers which accidental discovery surprises them most.

Ready to post

TITLE The X-Ray of a Hand That Shocked the World

DESCRIPTION How a glowing screen led to the first X-ray images in 1895.

HASHTAGS #history #science #xray

COVER TEXT He saw her bones

PIN Which accidental discovery should I cover next?

English Kings Kept Banning Football

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	English kings banned football again and again.	Medieval manuscript drawing of a ball game (public domain)	▶ Big card: BANNED	Playful
3–10	Medieval football wasn't a tidy match. Crowds chased a ball through streets, with few rules.	Re-creation: crowd silhouettes and a ball	❚❚ Pause after "streets"	Fun
10–18	In 1314, a proclamation in London banned it, worried about noise and disorder in the city.	Timeline graphic: 1314 marker	Label "1314"	Clear
18–27	Later, Edward III wanted men practising archery for war instead of playing ball games.	Manuscript drawing of archers (public domain)	Highlight "archery"	Explaining
27–36	Similar bans were repeated for centuries, in England and in Scotland, which suggests people kept playing anyway.	Timeline graphic: repeated ban markers	▶ New card per sentence	Wry
36–45 CTA	Football outlasted every single ban, and today it fills stadiums. Which modern sport would annoy a medieval king most?	Ball game drawing, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	The National Archives (UK): medieval proclamations · Britannica "football" (history section)
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a crowd chasing a ball through a medieval street.
2. Focus on Scotland, which passed similar bans.
3. Ask viewers which modern sport would annoy a medieval king.

Ready to post

TITLE English Kings Kept Banning Football

DESCRIPTION Why medieval kings banned football and ordered archery practice.

HASHTAGS #history #football #medieval

COVER TEXT Football was banned

PIN Which sport history should I cover next?

The Golden Spike That Joined a Continent

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	One golden spike finished a railroad across America.	Public-domain photo of the 1869 ceremony	▶ Big card: GOLDEN SPIKE	Bold
3–10	Two companies built toward each other, one from California and one from the Midwest.	Map: two lines approaching each other	Label “two companies”	Storyteller
10–18	Thousands of workers, many from China and Ireland, laid the track across mountains and plains.	Period photo of track workers (public domain)	❚❚ Pause after “Ireland”	Respectful
18–27	On May 10, 1869, the lines met at Promontory Summit, Utah. A telegraph sent one word: done.	Map pin on Promontory Summit	Highlight “done”	Moving
27–36	The golden spike was removed right after the ceremony. It is kept at a Stanford museum today.	Museum photo of the spike, open-access	▶ New card per sentence	Calm
36–45 CTA	A trip of weeks or months became about a week. Which turning-point day should I cover next?	Map, slow zoom out	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	National Park Service: Golden Spike National Historical Park · Stanford University: Cantor Arts Center
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the telegraph word DONE sent when the spike went in.
2. Focus on the workers, many from China and Ireland, who built it.
3. Ask viewers how long a coast-to-coast trip took before 1869.

Ready to post

TITLE The Golden Spike That Joined a Continent

DESCRIPTION The ceremony that completed America’s first transcontinental railroad.

HASHTAGS `#history` `#railroad` `#americanhistory`

COVER TEXT One spike. One railroad.

PIN Which turning-point day should I cover next?

Pompeii Had Street Food Counters

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Ancient Romans had street food counters, like fast food.	Public-domain photo of a Pompeii food counter	▶ Big card: ROMAN FAST FOOD	Playful
3–10	In Pompeii, archaeologists have found many counters called thermopolia along the streets.	Map of Pompeii with counter pins	Label “thermopolia”	Clear
10–18	Each had a masonry counter with large jars set into the top, for hot or dry food.	Diagram: counter with jars	⏸ Pause after “jars”	Explaining
18–27	Many city flats had no proper kitchen, so buying food outside was part of everyday life.	Re-creation: small flat without a kitchen	▶ New card per sentence	Storyteller
27–36	Some counters were painted with animals and scenes. Remains in jars suggest dishes with meat, fish and beans.	Close-up of a painted counter, open-licence	Highlight “meat, fish and beans”	Curious
36–45 CTA	Lunch on the go, about 2,000 years ago. What would you order in Pompeii?	Counter, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	Pompeii Archaeological Park: thermopolia · Britannica “Pompeii”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on a painted counter with jars set into the top.
2. Compare the menu with a modern food truck.
3. Ask viewers what they would order in ancient Pompeii.

Ready to post

TITLE Pompeii Had Street Food Counters

DESCRIPTION Ancient Romans grabbed hot food from street counters called thermopolia.

HASHTAGS #history #pompeii #ancientrome

COVER TEXT Roman fast food

PIN Which ancient everyday habit should I cover next?

The Mary Celeste: Found Sailing With No Crew

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 1872, a ship was found drifting, nobody aboard.	Public-domain painting of the Mary Celeste	▶ Big card: NOBODY ABOARD	Mysterious
3–10	The Mary Celeste had left New York for Genoa, carrying barrels of industrial alcohol.	Map: New York to Genoa route	Label “1872”	Storyteller
10–18	A month later, another ship found her drifting near the Azores. The crew of ten was gone.	Map pin near the Azores	⏸ Pause after “gone”	Hushed
18–27	Her cargo was mostly intact and there was food on board. Her lifeboat was missing.	Re-creation: empty davits where a boat hung	Highlight “lifeboat was missing”	Curious
27–36	One common theory: fear of a leak or fumes made them leave in the lifeboat, then they were lost.	Diagram: ship and small boat drifting apart	▶ New card per sentence	Careful
36–45 CTA	Nobody was ever found. What do you think made them leave the ship?	Painting, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Curious

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: “Mary Celeste” entry · Royal Museums Greenwich
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the missing lifeboat, the key clue.
2. Focus on the alcohol cargo and the leak theory.
3. Ask viewers which explanation they find most likely.

Ready to post

TITLE The Mary Celeste: Found Sailing With No Crew

DESCRIPTION The ship found adrift in 1872 with its crew missing.

HASHTAGS #history #unsolved #sailing

COVER TEXT Nobody aboard

PIN Which unsolved sea mystery should I cover next?

How the Rosetta Stone Unlocked Hieroglyphs

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	This broken stone let people read hieroglyphs again.	Museum open-access photo of the Rosetta Stone	▶ Big card: THE KEY	Intrigued
3–10	For over a thousand years, nobody could read Egyptian hieroglyphs. The knowledge had been lost.	Public-domain photo of temple hieroglyphs	❚❚ Pause after "lost"	Serious
10–18	In 1799, French soldiers in Egypt found a carved slab near the town of Rosetta.	Map pin on Rosetta, Nile Delta	Label "1799"	Storyteller
18–27	It carried one decree from 196 BC, written three times: in hieroglyphs, in Demotic script and in ancient Greek.	Diagram: three bands of text	▶ New card per script	Explaining
27–36	Scholars could read the Greek. So they had the same message in a script they knew, beside two they didn't.	Diagram: Greek band lit, arrows to others	Highlight "same message"	Building
36–45	Names like Ptolemy sat inside oval frames called cartouches. Matching those names gave the first sound values.	Close-up of a cartouche (public domain)	❚❚ Pause after "cartouches"	Curious
45–54	In 1822, Jean-François Champollion announced he could read the system. Egypt's own words could be read again.	Timeline graphic: 1799 → 1822	Highlight "1822"	Proud
54–60 CTA	The stone is in the British Museum. Which lost script would you want to read?	Slow zoom on the stone	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH The British Museum: the Rosetta Stone · Britannica "Rosetta Stone" and "Jean-François Champollion"

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** The Rosetta Stone is written in three languages. **Documented:** It has three scripts (hieroglyphs, Demotic and Greek) but two languages, Egyptian and Greek.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the cartouche of Ptolemy, the first name Champollion matched.
2. Focus on Thomas Young's earlier progress before Champollion's breakthrough.
3. Ask viewers which lost script they would most like to read.

Ready to post

TITLE How the Rosetta Stone Unlocked Hieroglyphs

DESCRIPTION How one broken stone helped decipher Egyptian hieroglyphs in 1822.

HASHTAGS #history #ancientegypt #rosettastone

COVER TEXT The key to hieroglyphs

PIN Which ancient script should I cover next?

Vikings Never Wore Horned Helmets. So Who Did?

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Vikings never wore horned helmets into battle.	1800s painting of a horned warrior (public domain), red X	▶ Big card: NEVER	Confident
3–10	That image is everywhere: cartoons, sports logos, costumes. But archaeologists have never found a Viking-age helmet with horns.	Your own quick doodles of horned helmets	❚❚ Pause before "But"	Teasing
10–18	The best-preserved one, the Gjermundbu helmet, was found in Norway in 1943. It's a rounded iron cap with eye guards.	Line drawing of the Gjermundbu helmet	Label "Gjermundbu, 1943"	Museum guide
18–27	No horns. Horns would be a terrible idea in a fight: they give a blade something to catch.	Re-creation: helmet outline, horns fade out	▶ New card per sentence	Dry
27–36	So where did the horns come from? Mostly the 1800s. Painters and costume designers gave Norse heroes horns and wings to look dramatic.	Timeline graphic: 800 → 1800s	❚❚ Pause after "the 1800s"	Curious
36–45	A famous example: the first full staging of Wagner's Ring cycle in 1876, whose costumes gave several characters horned helmets.	Period stage-design sketch (public domain)	Highlight "1876"	Storyteller
45–54	Real horned helmets do exist, found in Denmark. But they're Bronze Age ceremonial pieces, well over a thousand years older than the Viking age.	Map of Denmark, pin drops; timeline zooms out	❚❚ Pause before "well over"	Reveal, slower
54–60 CTA	What history fact did you learn as a kid that turned out wrong?	Freeze on the X-stamped painting	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm, direct

VERIFY WITH Encyclopaedia Britannica, "Viking" entry · Museum of Cultural History, University of Oslo: the Gjermundbu helmet

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Vikings wore horned helmets in battle. **Documented:** No horned Viking-age helmet has been found; the image spread through 19th-century art and opera costumes.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the Gjermundbu helmet, then reveal the myth at 10 s.
2. Swap the culprit: 1800s paintings instead of the opera.
3. Swap the CTA: ask where viewers first saw a horned Viking.

Ready to post

TITLE Vikings Never Wore Horned Helmets. So Who Did?

DESCRIPTION Where the horned-helmet myth really came from.

HASHTAGS #history #vikings #mythbusting

COVER TEXT Horns? Never.

PIN Which history myth should I check next?

How Polynesians Found Islands Without Maps

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	They crossed thousands of miles of ocean without maps.	Map of the Pacific triangle: Hawaii, New Zealand, Rapa Nui	▶ Big card: NO MAPS	Bold
3–10	Over many centuries, Polynesian navigators settled islands spread across a huge triangle of the Pacific.	Map: arrows spread island to island	Label “Polynesian triangle”	Storyteller
10–18	The last big ones, like Hawaii and New Zealand, were settled roughly 800 to 1,000 years ago.	Timeline graphic: settlement dates, rounded	Highlight “roughly”	Careful
18–27	Navigators read the night sky. They memorized where stars rose and set on the horizon, and steered by them.	Re-creation: star compass circle	⏸ Pause after “night sky”	Calm
27–36	By day they felt ocean swells against the hull. Swell patterns bend around islands long before land appears.	Diagram: swells bending around an island	▶ New card per sentence	Explaining
36–45	Birds helped too. Some seabirds fly out to fish in the morning and return to land at dusk.	Simple graphic: bird flight lines toward an island	Highlight “return to land”	Curious
45–54	Some once argued these islands were found by accident. Planned voyages explain the evidence better.	Map: two-way voyage arrows	⏸ Pause after “accident”	Clear
54–60 CTA	Stars, waves and birds. Which clue would you trust most on open water?	Starry sky over ocean, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Bishop Museum, Honolulu: Polynesian voyaging · Britannica “Polynesian culture”

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Polynesians reached remote islands by drifting there by accident. **Documented:** Evidence points to planned two-way voyages using stars, swells and birds.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on a star compass drawn in the sand.
2. Focus on one island group, such as Hawaii or New Zealand.
3. Ask viewers which navigation clue they would trust most.

Ready to post

TITLE How Polynesians Found Islands Without Maps

DESCRIPTION How Pacific navigators crossed open ocean using stars, swells and birds.

HASHTAGS #history #exploration #polynesia

COVER TEXT No maps. No compass.

PIN Which explorers should I cover next?

Galileo Didn't Invent the Telescope

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Galileo didn't invent the telescope. Here's who did.	Public-domain drawing of an early telescope	▶ Big card: NOT GALILEO	Confident
3–10	In 1608, Dutch spectacle maker Hans Lipperhey sought a patent for a device making distant things look closer.	Timeline graphic: 1608 marker	Label "1608"	Storyteller
10–18	He wasn't the only one. Other Dutch makers claimed it too, so the patent was not granted.	Re-creation: three claim papers	❚❚ Pause after "too"	Wry
18–27	News spread fast. In 1609, Galileo Galilei in Italy heard about it and built his own, much stronger version.	Map: Netherlands to Italy arrow	Highlight "his own"	Building
27–36	Then he did what made him famous: he pointed it at the sky and wrote down what he saw.	Museum photo of Galileo's telescope, open-access	▶ New card per sentence	Curious
36–45	He saw mountains on the Moon and, in 1610, four moons circling Jupiter.	Simple graphic: Jupiter with four dots	Highlight "four moons"	Amazed
45–54	So he didn't invent it. He turned a curiosity into a tool for astronomy.	Timeline graphic: 1608 → 1610	❚❚ Pause after "invent it"	Thoughtful
54–60 CTA	Which inventor do you think gets credit for someone else's idea?	Telescope drawing, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Museo Galileo, Florence: Galileo's telescopes · Britannica "Galileo" and "telescope"
MYTH CHECK	**Popular version:** Galileo invented the telescope. **Documented:** Dutch spectacle makers made the first known telescopes in 1608; Galileo improved the design in 1609.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the 1608 Dutch patent request.
2. Focus on Jupiter's moons and why they mattered.
3. Ask viewers which inventor gets credit for someone else's idea.

Ready to post

TITLE Galileo Didn't Invent the Telescope

DESCRIPTION Who really made the first telescope, and what Galileo did next.

HASHTAGS #history #science #galileo

COVER TEXT Not his invention

PIN Which invention myth should I check next?

Britain's Red Flag Law for Early Road Vehicles

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Early British vehicles needed a walker carrying a flag.	Re-creation: walker with red flag ahead of a steam vehicle	▶ Big card: RED FLAG	Playful
3–10	In 1865, Britain passed a Locomotive Act for steam-powered vehicles on public roads.	Timeline graphic: 1865 marker	Label "1865"	Clear
10–18	The speed limit was four miles an hour in the country and two miles an hour in towns.	Simple graphic: speedometer at 4 and 2	Highlight "two miles an hour"	Amazed
18–27	Each vehicle needed a crew, and one person had to walk in front, warning riders and horses, carrying a red flag.	Diagram: crew positions around the vehicle	⏸ Pause after "in front"	Explaining
27–36	Lawmakers worried about frightened horses, damaged roads and noisy machines. Horses were still the main traffic.	Period engraving of a busy road (public domain)	▶ New card per worry	Storyteller
36–45	In 1878 the flag rule was relaxed. Early petrol cars arrived, still under strict rules.	Timeline graphic: 1865 → 1878	⏸ Pause after "relaxed"	Steady
45–54	In 1896 a new law raised the limit to 14 miles an hour. Drivers celebrated with a run to Brighton.	Map: London to Brighton route	Highlight "14 miles an hour"	Fun
54–60 CTA	Which rule of today will look strange in 100 years?	Flag walker, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	UK Parliament: Locomotive Acts history · Britannica "automobile" (history section)
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on someone walking in front of a vehicle with a flag.
2. Focus on the 1896 celebration run from London to Brighton.
3. Ask viewers which modern rule will look strange in 100 years.

Ready to post

TITLE Britain's Red Flag Law for Early Road Vehicles

DESCRIPTION The 1865 law that put a walking flag-bearer ahead of road vehicles.

HASHTAGS #history #oddlaws #cars

COVER TEXT Walk ahead. Wave a flag.

PIN Which odd law should I cover next?

The Great Stink That Gave London Its Sewers

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	London smelled so bad in 1858, it built sewers.	Period cartoon of the Thames (public domain)	▶ Big card: THE GREAT STINK	Playful
3–10	For years, London's sewage and waste flowed straight into the River Thames, the same river many drew water from.	Map of the Thames through London	⏸ Pause after "Thames"	Serious
10–18	In the hot summer of 1858, the river's smell became so strong people called it the Great Stink.	Timeline graphic: summer 1858	Label "1858"	Storyteller
18–27	Parliament sat right beside the river. Curtains were reportedly soaked in chemicals to block the smell.	Engraving of the Houses of Parliament (public domain)	Highlight "beside the river"	Wry
27–36	Lawmakers who had delayed for years suddenly moved quickly and approved a huge sewer plan within weeks.	Re-creation: papers stamped approved	▶ New card per sentence	Building
36–45	Engineer Joseph Bazalgette designed it: large brick tunnels that carried waste away from central London.	Diagram: tunnels running beside the river	⏸ Pause after "Bazalgette"	Explaining
45–54	The new system helped end the city's cholera outbreaks, and parts of it are still in use today.	Photo of a Victorian sewer tunnel, open-licence	Highlight "still in use"	Proud
54–60 CTA	A bad smell changed a city. What hidden system in your town do you never think about?	Thames map, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	London Museum: the Great Stink · Britannica "Joseph Bazalgette"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the curtains soaked in chemicals at Parliament.
2. Focus on John Snow's 1854 cholera map that came before.
3. Ask viewers what hidden system in their city they never think about.

Ready to post

TITLE The Great Stink That Gave London Its Sewers

DESCRIPTION How one hot summer of river stench led to London's sewer system.

HASHTAGS #history #london #engineering

COVER TEXT London smelled awful

PIN Which city engineering story should I cover next?

The Penny Black and the Birth of the Stamp

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	This tiny black stamp changed how letters got paid.	Museum open-access image of the Penny Black	▶ Big card: 1840	Intrigued
3–10	Before 1840, British letters were usually paid for by the person receiving them, priced by distance and sheets.	Re-creation: letter with postage marks	Label “receiver paid”	Clear
10–18	That made post expensive and slow to collect. Some people refused letters to avoid paying.	Simple graphic: letter returned to sender	⏸ Pause after “paying”	Storyteller
18–27	A reformer named Rowland Hill proposed one cheap rate, paid in advance by the sender.	Timeline graphic: reform proposal	Highlight “paid in advance”	Explaining
27–36	In 1840, Britain introduced the uniform penny post. One penny sent a light letter anywhere in the country.	Map of Britain, letters fly in all directions	▶ New card per sentence	Building
36–45	On May 6, 1840, the Penny Black became valid, the world’s first adhesive postage stamp.	Close-up of the stamp	Highlight “first adhesive stamp”	Proud
45–54	Letter numbers rose sharply within a few years, and other countries soon introduced their own stamps.	Map: stamps spread across countries	⏸ Pause after “sharply”	Steady
54–60 CTA	Today, billions of stamps later, when did you last send a paper letter?	Stamp, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	The Postal Museum, London: the Penny Black · Britannica “Rowland Hill”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on a close-up of the Penny Black stamp.
2. Focus on how letters were paid for before 1840.
3. Ask viewers when they last posted a paper letter.

Ready to post

TITLE The Penny Black and the Birth of the Stamp

DESCRIPTION How a one-penny stamp changed how the world sends letters.

HASHTAGS #history #stamps #everydayhistory

COVER TEXT One penny, any distance

PIN Which everyday invention should I trace next?

The Indus Script Still Can't Be Read

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Thousands of these seals survive. Nobody can read them.	Museum open-access photo of an Indus seal	▶ Big card: UNREAD	Mysterious
3–10	The Indus civilization grew along rivers in today's Pakistan and northwest India, about 4,500 years ago.	Map of the Indus Valley region	Label "c. 2600 BC"	Storyteller
10–18	Its cities, like Mohenjo-daro, had planned streets, brick houses and covered drains.	Public-domain photo of Mohenjo-daro ruins	Highlight "covered drains"	Amazed
18–27	They also left thousands of small carved seals, often with an animal and a short row of symbols.	Diagram: seal parts labelled	❚❚ Pause after "symbols"	Curious
27–36	The inscriptions are very short, usually just a few signs. That gives code-breakers little to work with.	Simple graphic: five signs in a row	▶ New card per sentence	Explaining
36–45	There is no known bilingual text, like the Rosetta Stone, that pairs this script with a known one.	Re-creation: Rosetta Stone outline, crossed out	Highlight "no bilingual text"	Serious
45–54	Many decipherments have been proposed. None is widely accepted, and scholars even debate what language it records.	Re-creation: question marks over signs	❚❚ Pause after "accepted"	Careful
54–60 CTA	Which lost script do you think will be cracked next?	Seal, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Curious

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Indus civilization" and "Indus script" entries · National Museum, New Delhi
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the famous unicorn seal.
2. Focus on the city of Mohenjo-daro and its drains.
3. Ask viewers which lost language they think will be cracked next.

Ready to post

TITLE The Indus Script Still Can't Be Read

DESCRIPTION Why the writing of the Indus civilization remains undeciphered.

HASHTAGS #history #unsolved #ancient

COVER TEXT Still unreadable

PIN Which undeciphered script should I cover next?

The Antikythera Mechanism: An Ancient Gear Machine

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	This corroded shipwreck lump is full of ancient gears.	Museum open-access photo of the Antikythera fragments	▶ Big card: GEARS	Intrigued
3–10	In 1901, sponge divers recovered objects from an ancient wreck near the Greek island of Antikythera.	Map pin on Antikythera	Label “1901”	Storyteller
10–18	Among statues and pottery were some lumps of corroded bronze. Months later someone noticed a gear wheel.	Re-creation: museum crate with fragments	⏸ Pause after “gear wheel”	Curious
18–27	Scans in modern times revealed dozens of interlocking gears and tiny inscriptions inside the fragments.	Diagram: gear layout, simple outline	Highlight “dozens of gears”	Amazed
27–36	It was likely made around the second or first century BC. Dates vary between studies.	Timeline graphic: 200–1 BC range	⏸ Pause after “vary”	Careful
36–45	Turning a handle moved dials showing the Sun, the Moon and predicted eclipses.	Diagram: front dial with pointers	▶ New card per dial	Explaining
45–54	Nothing this complex is known again until the medieval astronomical clocks of Europe, many centuries later.	Timeline graphic: gap to medieval clocks	Highlight “many centuries”	Thoughtful
54–60 CTA	Who built it, and exactly why, is still unknown. Which ancient object would you want to study?	Fragments, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	National Archaeological Museum, Athens: the Antikythera Mechanism · Britannica “Antikythera mechanism”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on divers working the wreck in 1901.
2. Focus on the eclipse dial and how it predicted eclipses.
3. Ask viewers which ancient object they would study.

Ready to post

TITLE The Antikythera Mechanism: An Ancient Gear Machine

DESCRIPTION The ancient Greek gear device that modelled the sky.

HASHTAGS #history #ancientgreece #science

COVER TEXT Ancient gears

PIN Which ancient object should I cover next?

The Lewis Chessmen Found on a Scottish Island

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Medieval chess pieces turned up on a Scottish island.	Museum open-access photo of the Lewis chessmen	▶ Big card: FOUND 1831	Intrigued
3–10	In 1831 a hoard of small carved figures was found on the Isle of Lewis, in Scotland's Outer Hebrides.	Map pin on the Isle of Lewis	Label "1831"	Storyteller
10–18	There were dozens of chess pieces: kings, queens, bishops, knights and warders, plus game pieces.	Simple graphic: piece types in a row	▶ New card per piece	Clear
18–27	Most are carved from walrus ivory, some from whale teeth. They date to around the late 1100s.	Close-up of the ivory carving, open-access	Highlight "walrus ivory"	Explaining
27–36	Their style suggests they were probably made in Norway, perhaps in Trondheim, then carried west.	Map: Norway to the Hebrides route	❚❚ Pause after "Trondheim"	Careful
36–45	How they ended up buried on Lewis is not known. A merchant's stock is one idea.	Re-creation: small bag buried in sand	Highlight "not known"	Curious
45–54	Some warders bite the tops of their shields, which makes them one of the most loved museum objects.	Close-up of a shield-biting warder	❚❚ Pause after "shields"	Fun
54–60 CTA	Which piece would you put on your board?	Pieces lined up, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	The British Museum and National Museum of Scotland: the Lewis chessmen · Britannica "Lewis chessmen"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the warder biting his shield.
2. Focus on walrus ivory and the trade routes it reveals.
3. Ask viewers which piece they would want on their board.

Ready to post

TITLE The Lewis Chessmen Found on a Scottish Island

DESCRIPTION The walrus-ivory chess pieces found on Lewis in 1831.

HASHTAGS #history #medieval #chess

COVER TEXT Medieval chess set

PIN Which medieval object should I cover next?

Shackleton's Endurance: Every Crew Member Survived

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Ice crushed their ship. Every crew member survived.	Public-domain photo of Endurance in pack ice	▶ Big card: ALL SURVIVED	Moving
3–10	In 1914, the explorer Ernest Shackleton sailed south, aiming to cross the whole of Antarctica on foot.	Map of Antarctica with planned route	Label "1914"	Storyteller
10–18	In early 1915 his ship, Endurance, was trapped in sea ice. Months later the ice crushed it and it sank.	Timeline graphic: trapped → sank	❚❚ Pause after "trapped"	Serious
18–27	The 28 men camped on drifting ice, then took three small boats to tiny Elephant Island.	Map: drift and boat route	Highlight "Elephant Island"	Tense
27–36	Shackleton and five others sailed a small lifeboat about 800 miles to South Georgia to get help.	Map: Elephant Island to South Georgia	▶ New card per sentence	Building
36–45	Then they crossed the island's mountains to reach a whaling station. Rescue took several attempts.	Simple graphic: mountain crossing line	❚❚ Pause after "whaling station"	Steady
45–54	In August 1916, a Chilean ship rescued all the men left on Elephant Island.	Public-domain photo of the rescue	Highlight "all"	Relief
54–60 CTA	All of them came home. What quality would you most want in a leader?	Endurance photo, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH Scott Polar Research Institute, University of Cambridge · Royal Geographical Society: Endurance expedition

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Shackleton recruited his crew with a newspaper ad promising 'safe return doubtful.' **Documented:** No original copy of that advert has ever been found.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the ship trapped in sea ice, using the expedition's own photos.
2. Focus on the small boat voyage to South Georgia.
3. Ask viewers what quality they would want in a leader.

Ready to post

TITLE Shackleton's Endurance: Every Crew Member Survived

DESCRIPTION How the Endurance crew all survived after losing their ship to ice.

HASHTAGS #history #exploration #antarctica

COVER TEXT Everyone came home

PIN Which survival story should I cover next?

Marie Curie's Two Nobel Prizes

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Marie Curie won Nobel Prizes in two different sciences.	Public-domain photo of Curie's laboratory	▶ Big card: 2 PRIZES	Proud
3–10	She was born in Warsaw in 1867 and moved to Paris to study physics and mathematics.	Map: Warsaw to Paris	Label "1867"	Storyteller
10–18	With her husband Pierre, she studied the strange rays given off by uranium and other minerals.	Re-creation: mineral sample and measuring device	❚❚ Pause after "uranium"	Explaining
18–27	In 1898 they announced two new elements: polonium, named after Poland, and radium.	Simple graphic: two element tiles	Highlight "polonium"	Building
27–36	In 1903 she shared the Nobel Prize in Physics. She was the first woman to win one.	Timeline graphic: 1903 marker	▶ New card per sentence	Proud
36–45	In 1911 she won the Nobel Prize in Chemistry on her own, for her work on radium and polonium.	Timeline graphic: 1903 → 1911	Highlight "1911"	Amazed
45–54	Her notebooks are still radioactive today, and readers reportedly handle them with protective precautions.	Re-creation: notebook in a lined box	❚❚ Pause after "radioactive"	Careful
54–60 CTA	Her story is still taught worldwide. Which scientist do you think deserves more fame?	Lab photo, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Musée Curie, Paris · The Nobel Prize: Marie Curie facts · Britannica "Marie Curie"
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on her notebooks, still kept with safety precautions.
2. Focus on the discovery of polonium, named after Poland.
3. Ask viewers which scientist should be more famous.

Ready to post

TITLE Marie Curie's Two Nobel Prizes

DESCRIPTION How Marie Curie won Nobel Prizes in two different sciences.

HASHTAGS #history #science #mariecurie

COVER TEXT Two sciences. Two prizes.

PIN Which scientist should I cover next?

Britain's Hair Powder Tax

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 1795, Britain taxed people for powdering their hair.	Period portrait with powdered wig (public domain)	▶ Big card: HAIR TAX	Playful
3–10	Powdered wigs and hair were high fashion in the 1700s. The powder was usually made from starch or flour.	Re-creation: powder box and puff	Label "starch or flour"	Explaining
10–18	Britain was at war with France, and the government needed money. Food prices were also rising.	Timeline graphic: 1795 marker	❚❚ Pause after "money"	Clear
18–27	Prime Minister William Pitt introduced a duty: anyone using hair powder had to buy a yearly certificate.	Simple graphic: certificate with a seal	Highlight "yearly certificate"	Storyteller
27–36	Some exceptions applied, for example to the royal family and some clergy, and certain servants were covered by employers.	Re-creation: list with ticks	▶ New card per sentence	Matter-of-fact
36–45	Many people simply stopped powdering. Fashion was already moving toward natural hair, and the tax sped it up.	Before/after silhouettes: powdered vs natural	❚❚ Pause after "stopped powdering"	Wry
45–54	Few people still paid by the 1800s. The tax was finally repealed in 1869.	Timeline graphic: 1795 → 1869	Highlight "1869"	Steady
54–60 CTA	Which fashion would you happily see taxed?	Portrait, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	The National Archives (UK): hair powder duty records · Britannica "wig" (history section)
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a powdered wig in a period portrait.
2. Focus on the flour shortage that made the tax popular.
3. Ask viewers which fashion they would happily see taxed.

Ready to post

TITLE Britain's Hair Powder Tax

DESCRIPTION The 1795 tax that helped end powdered hair in Britain.

HASHTAGS #history #oddlaws #georgian

COVER TEXT Pay to powder

PIN Which odd tax should I cover next?

The Day Sputnik Started Beeping From Orbit

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 1957, a metal ball started beeping from orbit.	Public-domain image of Sputnik 1	▶ Big card: OCT 4, 1957	Intrigued
3–10	The Soviet Union launched Sputnik 1, the first human-made object to orbit Earth.	Simple graphic: Earth with an orbit line	Label “first satellite”	Bold
10–18	It was a polished sphere about 58 centimetres wide, with four long antennas trailing behind.	Diagram: sphere and four antennas	Highlight “58 centimetres”	Explaining
18–27	It circled Earth about once every 96 minutes, sending simple radio beeps that amateur listeners could pick up.	Animation: dot circling Earth	⏸ Pause after “96 minutes”	Curious
27–36	People around the world tuned in. In the United States, the news caused real alarm.	Re-creation: radio with sound waves	▶ New card per sentence	Tense
36–45	The next year, the US launched its first satellite and created NASA. The space race had begun.	Timeline graphic: 1957 → 1958	Highlight “space race”	Building
45–54	Sputnik’s batteries ran out after about three weeks. In early 1958 it fell back and burned up.	Animation: orbit decays	⏸ Pause after “three weeks”	Reflective
54–60 CTA	It weighed about 84 kilograms. Which space first would you have wanted to watch live?	Sputnik, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	NASA History Office: Sputnik and the dawn of the space age · Britannica “Sputnik”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on the beep sound, then reveal what it was.
2. Focus on the US reaction and the founding of NASA in 1958.
3. Ask viewers which space first they would have watched live.

Ready to post

TITLE The Day Sputnik Started Beeping From Orbit

DESCRIPTION How a small beeping satellite launched the space age in 1957.

HASHTAGS #history #space #sputnik

COVER TEXT Beep. Beep. Beep.

PIN Which space history day should I cover next?

Before Railways, Every Town Kept Its Own Time

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Before railways, every British town kept its own time.	Period photo of a town clock (public domain)	▶ Big card: OWN TIME	Intrigued
3–10	Towns set their clocks by the sun. Noon was when the sun was highest over that town.	Diagram: sun over two towns	❚❚ Pause after “that town”	Explaining
10–18	So a western town like Bristol ran about ten minutes behind London, every single day.	Map: London and Bristol with clocks	Highlight “ten minutes”	Clear
18–27	That was fine for horses. But trains moved fast, and timetables with different local times caused confusion.	Re-creation: timetable with two times	▶ New card per sentence	Storyteller
27–36	In the 1840s, railway companies began using London time, also called railway time, across their networks.	Map: rail lines with matching clocks	Label “railway time”	Steady
36–45	Some towns showed both times for years. A few clocks even had two minute hands. Bristol’s Corn Exchange clock still does.	Simple graphic: clock with two minute hands	❚❚ Pause after “both times”	Fun
45–54	In 1880, a law made Greenwich Mean Time the legal time across Great Britain.	Timeline graphic: 1840s → 1880	Highlight “1880”	Proud
54–60 CTA	How would you plan a trip if every town kept its own time?	Clock, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Royal Museums Greenwich: Greenwich Mean Time and railway time · Britannica “standard time”
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on a clock with two minute hands, one for local time.
2. Focus on the 1884 meeting that set Greenwich as the world’s prime meridian.
3. Ask viewers how they would plan a trip with different town times.

Ready to post

TITLE Before Railways, Every Town Kept Its Own Time

DESCRIPTION How railways pushed Britain to set every clock to one time.

HASHTAGS #history #everydayhistory #railways

COVER TEXT Every town had its own time

PIN Which everyday system should I explain next?

Whatever Happened to Rome's Ninth Legion?

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	A whole Roman legion vanishes from the records.	Museum open-access photo of a Roman inscription	▶ Big card: VANISHED	Mysterious
3–10	The Ninth Legion, about five thousand soldiers, served in Roman Britain and helped found the fortress at York.	Map of Roman Britain, pin on York	Label "York"	Storyteller
10–18	An inscription in York, from around AD 108, is the last firm record of it in Britain.	Timeline graphic: AD 108 marker	Highlight "last firm record"	Clear
18–27	After that, it is missing from later lists of legions. So what happened to it?	Re-creation: list with one gap	❚❚ Pause after "legions"	Curious
27–36	The popular story says it marched into Scotland and was destroyed. A famous 1954 novel spread that version.	Re-creation: map of Scotland with question mark	▶ New card per sentence	Teasing
36–45	But no Roman source records that defeat. Some finds suggest parts of it later served near the Rhine.	Map: Britain to the Rhine arrow	Highlight "no Roman source"	Careful
45–54	Historians still debate whether it was lost in a war in the east or disbanded.	Timeline graphic: possible endings with question marks	❚❚ Pause after "debate"	Thoughtful
54–60 CTA	Which theory do you think fits the evidence best?	Inscription, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Curious

VERIFY WITH Encyclopaedia Britannica: "legion" entry · Yorkshire Museum, York: Ninth Legion inscription

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** The Ninth Legion was wiped out in Scotland around AD 117. **Documented:** There is no record of such a defeat; later traces suggest it served elsewhere. Its end is unknown.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the stone inscription found in York.
2. Focus on the 1954 novel that made the disappearance story famous.
3. Ask viewers which theory the evidence supports best.

Ready to post

TITLE Whatever Happened to Rome's Ninth Legion?

DESCRIPTION What the evidence says about Rome's missing Ninth Legion.

HASHTAGS #history #ancientrome #unsolved

COVER TEXT A legion vanishes

PIN Which Roman mystery should I cover next?

Hannibal Took War Elephants Over the Alps

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	In 218 BC, elephants marched over the Alps.	Period painting of the Alps crossing (public domain)	▶ Big card: 218 BC	Bold
3–10	Hannibal was a general from Carthage, in North Africa, at war with Rome.	Map: Carthage and Rome	Label "Carthage"	Storyteller
10–18	Instead of attacking by sea, he marched from Spain, across southern Gaul and over the mountains.	Map: route from Spain to Italy	Highlight "over the mountains"	Building
18–27	He brought war elephants, reportedly about 37 of them, along with tens of thousands of soldiers.	Simple graphic: elephant icons	❚❚ Pause after "37 of them"	Amazed
27–36	The crossing happened in autumn, with snow, narrow paths and steep drops. Many men and animals were lost.	Re-creation: narrow path with snow	▶ New card per sentence	Serious
36–45	Ancient writers describe the march, but nobody agrees which pass he used. Several are proposed.	Map: several possible passes with question marks	❚❚ Pause after "which pass"	Careful
45–54	He reached Italy and won major battles there, but Rome won the war in the end.	Timeline graphic: 218 → 201 BC	Highlight "Rome won"	Reflective
54–60 CTA	It remains one of history's most famous marches. Which ancient journey do you think was the hardest?	Alps painting, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Hannibal" and "Second Punic War" entries
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on a snowy mountain pass and the sound of an elephant.
2. Focus on the debate about which pass he used.
3. Ask viewers which ancient journey they think was hardest.

Ready to post

TITLE Hannibal Took War Elephants Over the Alps

DESCRIPTION How Hannibal crossed the Alps with elephants to reach Italy.

HASHTAGS #history #ancient #hannibal

COVER TEXT Elephants in the Alps

PIN Which ancient journey should I cover next?

Magna Carta Was Cancelled Within Weeks

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Magna Carta failed within weeks. It became famous anyway.	Public-domain image of a Magna Carta manuscript	▶ Big card: FAILED FIRST	Intrigued
3–10	In June 1215, rebel barons forced King John to agree to a charter at Runnymede, near London.	Map pin on Runnymede	Label "June 1215"	Storyteller
10–18	It promised that the king would follow the law, and limited unfair taxes and seizures.	Re-creation: charter with wax seal	⏸ Pause after "follow the law"	Explaining
18–27	The popular version says it gave rights to everyone. In fact it mostly protected barons and free men.	Simple graphic: small group highlighted in a crowd	Highlight "mostly barons"	Careful
27–36	John asked the Pope to cancel it. Within about ten weeks it was annulled, and war followed.	Timeline graphic: June → August 1215	▶ New card per sentence	Tense
36–45	After John died, it was reissued several times, and later versions entered English law.	Timeline graphic: 1216, 1217, 1225 markers	⏸ Pause after "reissued"	Steady
45–54	Only a few of its clauses are still law in England today, but its ideas spread far.	Close-up of manuscript text	Highlight "still law"	Reflective
54–60 CTA	Which old document do you think still matters most?	Manuscript, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Warm

VERIFY WITH The British Library: Magna Carta · The National Archives (UK): Magna Carta

MYTH CHECK **Popular version:** Magna Carta gave rights to all English people in 1215. **Documented:** It mainly protected barons and free men; it was annulled within weeks and reissued later.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on the meadow at Runnymede beside the Thames.
2. Focus on clause 39 and why it is still quoted.
3. Ask viewers which old document they think still matters most.

Ready to post

TITLE Magna Carta Was Cancelled Within Weeks

DESCRIPTION The 1215 charter that failed at first, then became famous.

HASHTAGS #history #medieval #magnacarta

COVER TEXT It failed. Then it lasted.

PIN Which famous document should I cover next?

When Maps Showed California as an Island

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	For a century, maps showed California as an island.	Public-domain map with California as an island	▶ Big card: AN ISLAND?	Playful
3–10	Early Spanish explorers had mapped it correctly in the 1500s, as a long peninsula.	Old map showing a peninsula (public domain)	Label “1500s”	Storyteller
10–18	Then in the early 1600s, island maps appeared. One possible source was a misread or exaggerated expedition report.	Timeline graphic: early 1600s marker	❚❚ Pause after “appeared”	Curious
18–27	Mapmakers in Europe copied each other. Once one famous map showed an island, many more followed.	Re-creation: maps copied in a chain	▶ New card per sentence	Explaining
27–36	Few people in Europe could check. Most mapmakers never travelled to the places they drew.	Simple graphic: mapmaker at a desk, ocean between	Highlight “never travelled”	Wry
36–45	Overland trips by missionaries around 1700 showed that California was joined to the mainland.	Map: overland route around the gulf	❚❚ Pause after “joined”	Clear
45–54	Even so, island maps kept appearing for decades, until a Spanish decree in 1747 declared California not an island.	Timeline graphic: 1700 → 1747	Highlight “1747”	Reveal
54–60 CTA	Old maps can be wrong for a long time. Which old map mistake do you find funniest?	Island map, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	Library of Congress: Geography and Map Division · Stanford University Libraries: California as an Island collection
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it’s your video

1. Open on an old map where California floats off the coast.
2. Focus on the expedition that showed it was connected to land.
3. Ask viewers which old map error they find funniest.

Ready to post

TITLE When Maps Showed California as an Island

DESCRIPTION Why European maps showed California as an island for over a century.

HASHTAGS #history #maps #exploration

COVER TEXT California, the island

PIN Which old map mistake should I cover next?

Canned Food Came Before the Can Opener

BEAT TIMELINE (SECONDS)

0 3 10 18 27 36 45 54 60

TIME (S)	VOICEOVER	VISUAL	CAPTION / PAUSE	TONE
0–3 HOOK	Canned food existed for decades before the can opener.	Period illustration of early tin cans (public domain)	▶ Big card: NO OPENER	Playful
3–10	In the 1790s, France needed a better way to feed its army and navy on long campaigns.	Timeline graphic: 1790s marker	Label "1790s"	Storyteller
10–18	A confectioner named Nicolas Appert sealed cooked food in glass jars and heated them. The food kept for months.	Re-creation: glass jars in boiling water	⏸ Pause after "heated them"	Explaining
18–27	Nobody yet knew why it worked. Germs weren't understood until Louis Pasteur's work decades later.	Timeline graphic: Appert → Pasteur	Highlight "decades later"	Curious
27–36	In 1810, a British patent covered sealing food in tin-plated iron cans, which were tougher than glass.	Simple graphic: jar becomes can	▶ New card per sentence	Clear
36–45	Early cans were thick and heavy. Users reportedly opened them with tools like hammers and chisels.	Re-creation: hammer and chisel beside a can	⏸ Pause after "hammers"	Wry
45–54	Dedicated can openers only appeared around the 1850s, once cans became thinner.	Timeline graphic: 1810 → 1850s	Highlight "1850s"	Reveal
54–60 CTA	Which other invention do you think came in the wrong order?	Can, slow zoom	Hold question 1.5 s	Fun

VERIFY WITH	Encyclopaedia Britannica: "Nicolas Appert" and "canning" entries · Science Museum, London
MYTH CHECK	No common myth.

Make it yours

3 swaps so it's your video

1. Open on an old instruction to open cans with a hammer.
2. Focus on Appert's glass jars before the tin can.
3. Ask viewers which invention came in the wrong order.

Ready to post

TITLE Canned Food Came Before the Can Opener

DESCRIPTION Why the tin can arrived decades before anyone could open it easily.

HASHTAGS #history #inventions #food

COVER TEXT No can opener

PIN Which invention came in the wrong order?

Turn a script into a video in 6 steps

A generic workflow that works with any text-to-speech tool, any video editor and any images you have the rights to.

1. **Personalize and check**
   Apply at least one “Make it yours” swap and look up the core fact in the “Verify with” reference. Read the script aloud once with a timer.

2. **Record the voiceover**
   Paste the Voiceover column into any text-to-speech tool, or record yourself at about 150 words per minute. Leave the pauses in the Caption / pause column.

3. **Gather visuals you have rights to**
   Public-domain paintings and old maps, museum open-access photos, your own sketches, simple re-creations and timeline graphics made in any design tool.

4. **Cut beat by beat**
   Use the Time (s) column as your edit list: one cut or overlay change at each beat boundary. The beat timeline on each page shows where they fall.

5. **Add captions**
   Big captions, 1–3 words per card. Highlight the words named in the Caption / pause column and hold the final question on screen for about 1.5 s.

6. **Post and pin**
   Use the “Ready to post” box: title, description, hashtags and cover text. Turn on any disclosure the platform requires, and pin the suggested comment.

Batch tip: the CSV edit list

Open `script_beats.csv` in Google Sheets or Excel and filter by `script_id`. Each row is one beat with start and end seconds, voiceover, visual, caption and tone: an edit list you can keep open next to your editor.

Make a series

Pair a script with a hook of the same theme from the library for a second video, or use the “Make it yours” swaps to film a new angle on the same event.

FAQ

Which themes are covered?
8 themes: Ancient world; Medieval life; Exploration & navigation; Inventions & science history; Odd laws & customs; Turning-point days; Everyday life in the past; Lost & unsolved. Each has at least 7 scripts.

How many hooks are there?
150 hooks: 10 hook types × 15 hooks each (H001–H150). The first 6 types are history-specific structures. Each hook is tagged with one of the 8 themes.

What is NOT covered?
True crime, gore or atrocity detail, war-crime retellings, modern politics (events after 1991), living people, religion debates, conspiracy theories, and non-English text.

Can I add my own hooks?
Yes. hooks.csv is a plain spreadsheet you can extend with your own rows. There is no generator.

Does it batch-generate a week of scripts?
No. It is a library of 60 finished scripts, not a generator or an app.

Does the same story come in 30, 45 and 60 s versions?
No. Each story is written at one length only: 20 stories at 30 s, 20 at 45 s and 20 at 60 s. The longest script is 60 s.

Are the facts guaranteed?
No. They come from widely documented history, but we are not professional historians. Check each fact against the named “Verify with” reference before posting.

Can I use it on a monetized channel?
Yes, on your own channels. See the License page. You can’t resell or share the scripts as a script product.

License

Simple version: use the scripts in your own content as much as you like; don't resell or share the pack.

You can

- Use any hook or script, as written or edited, in your own videos, Shorts, Reels, posts and captions.
- Use them for personal or commercial purposes, including your own monetized channels, on any number of your own channels.
- Edit, shorten, extend, translate or combine them, and read them with your own voice or any text-to-speech voice.
- Import the CSV files into your own tools, sheets and editing workflows, and add your own rows.

You can't

- Resell, share, give away or upload this pack, the PDFs or the CSV files, in whole or in part.
- Publish the scripts or hooks as a script product: a script pack, template, prompt pack, course, e-book or any other text product.

Good to know

- One purchase covers one creator, or one channel team working on the same channels.
- Check each fact against the named reference before posting; you are responsible for what you publish.
- Faceless Creator Kit is an independent shop and is not affiliated with any video platform, museum or publisher named in this book.

Thank you for buying from Faceless Creator Kit.